GREENTOWN BIBLE INSTITUTE

God’s Words Preserved

Manuscript Evidence

Inspiration, preservation, and purification; the Hebrew and Greek texts; and the King James Bible

Instructor Copy

Course syllabus · Introduction and twenty-two lessons · Two trimesters

Name _____

Class year _____

Course Syllabus

Course	God’s Words Preserved: Manuscript Evidence
Institution	Greentown Bible Institute
Term	Two trimesters of the September–May calendar; twenty-three class sessions of one hour
Meetings	Day and time _____ Room _____
Instructor	_____ Contact _____
Prerequisite	None. Bring a King James Bible, this workbook, and a pen to every session.

Course Description

A study of the biblical doctrine of Scripture and the history of its transmission. The course establishes from the Bible the doctrines of revelation, inspiration, preservation, and purification, and then examines the evidence of the Hebrew Old Testament, the Greek New Testament, the ancient versions and fathers, the printed Received Text, and the English Bible from Wycliffe to 1611. It concludes with translation method, the doctrinal significance of textual differences, and common questions concerning the King James Bible.

Course Rationale

The contest over the Bible once concerned what it teaches; it now concerns where it is to be found. The believer is a soldier (2 Tim. 2:3–4) whose weapon is *the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God* (Eph. 6:17). This course equips him to know where that Word is, why he may trust it, and how to give an answer *with meekness and fear* (1 Pet. 3:15).

Method

The course proceeds from Scripture to history. Biblical promises and principles are established first; manuscripts, versions, fathers, and printed editions are then examined in their light. Class sessions follow the numbered outline of the workbook, with Scripture read aloud, blanks completed, and one review question discussed at the close of each lesson.

Course Objectives

Upon completing the course, the student will be able to:

1. Define and distinguish revelation, inspiration, illumination, preservation, purification, and propagation, citing the principal texts for each.
2. Explain from Scripture the doctrine of verbal, plenary inspiration and the promise of providential preservation.
3. Describe the materials, forms, and scripts of biblical manuscripts and trace the stages from autograph to printed text and translation.
4. Explain the custody of the Old Testament in the Masoretic tradition and evaluate the Dead Sea Scrolls and the Septuagint in relation to it.
5. Summarize the manuscript, versional, and patristic evidence for the Received Text and evaluate the Alexandrian codices.
6. Narrate the history of the English Bible from Wycliffe to 1611, including the rules, companies, and review process of the King James translators.
7. Distinguish formal from dynamic equivalence and assess the doctrinal significance of differences between the King James Bible and modern versions.
8. Answer common objections from Scripture and evidence, *in meekness instructing those that oppose themselves* (2 Tim. 2:25).
9. Research and write a documented paper in Turabian style.

Required Texts

- *The Holy Bible*, King James Version.
- *God's Words Preserved: Manuscript Evidence* (this workbook).
- D. A. Waite, *Defending the King James Bible: A Fourfold Superiority*, 3rd ed. (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2006). Read in full during the course, marking highlights; submit the marked copy with the research paper.

Recommended Reading

- Edward F. Hills, *The King James Version Defended*, 5th ed. (Des Moines, IA: Christian Research Press, 2006).
- Jack Moorman, *Forever Settled: A Survey of the Documents and History of the Bible* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 1985).
- John William Burgon, *The Revision Revised* (London: John Murray, 1883).
- Alexander W. McClure, *The Translators Revived* (New York: Charles Scribner, 1853).
- Samuel C. Gipp, *Gipp's Understandable History of the Bible* (Miamitown, OH: Day Star Publishing, 2004).
- F. H. A. Scrivener, *The Authorized Edition of the English Bible (1611)* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1884).

Course Requirements

1. *Attendance and participation.* Attend each session, complete the blanks, and prepare the review question. A student who misses a session obtains the notes before the next class.
2. *Scripture memory.* Memorize the ten passages listed below; five are written at each examination.
3. *Reading.* Read Waite's *Defending the King James Bible* in full, marking key statements, and follow the recommended preparation in the schedule.
4. *Examinations.* A take-home Trimester One Examination follows Lesson 11. The Final Examination covers Lessons 12–22 and includes one cumulative essay question.
5. *Research paper.* "The Men and Their Methods" (see the following page).

Evaluation

Component	Weight
Attendance, participation, and completed workbook pages	15%
Scripture memory (ten passages, written at the examinations)	10%
Reading: *Defending the King James Bible*, highlighted and submitted with the paper	5%
Trimester One Examination (Introduction and Lessons 1–11)	20%
Final Examination (Lessons 12–22, with a cumulative essay question)	17%
Research paper: "The Men and Their Methods"	33%

Grading Scale

A	B	C	D	F
93–100	85–92	77–84	70–76	Below 70

Course Policies

Scripture is quoted from the King James Bible. Written work follows Kate L. Turabian, *A Manual for Writers of Research Papers, Theses, and Dissertations*, 9th ed. (notes-bibliography style). All submitted work must be the student's own; quotations and borrowed information are acknowledged in footnotes. Late work is accepted only by arrangement with the instructor.

Research Paper: "The Men and Their Methods"

The paper, worth one third of the final grade, examines the translators of the King James Bible and the method by which their work was done.

1. *Title and length.* The title is "The Men and Their Methods." Length is twelve to twenty-four pages, double-spaced, excluding the front matter and bibliography.
2. *Format.* Include a cover page, a table of contents, footnotes, and a bibliography in Turabian style. Present the paper in a notebook or binder.
3. *The men.* Choose seven translators and write a brief but thorough biography of each, showing his training, languages, company, and part in the work.
4. *The method.* Explain in detail how the translation was made and completed: the Hampton Court Conference, the fifteen rules, the six companies, the stages of review, the final committee, and the printing of 1611.
5. *Sources.* Use at least six sources, including primary sources such as "The Translators to the Reader" and the rules of 1604. Waite, McClure, and Allen are recommended starting points.
6. *Due date.* _____. Submit the paper together with the highlighted copy of Waite.

Scripture Memory

Trimester One	Trimester Two
1. 2 Timothy 3:16–17	6. Isaiah 40:8
2. 2 Peter 1:20–21	7. Proverbs 30:5–6
3. Psalm 12:6–7	8. Romans 3:1–2
4. Matthew 24:35	9. Romans 10:17
5. Psalm 119:89	10. 1 Peter 1:23–25

Using This Workbook

Each lesson opens with its chapter heading, key texts, and objectives, and closes with a review question. Scripture is printed in *italics*; other quotations appear in quotation marks. Footnotes document key historical and textual claims, and full references appear in the bibliography. The appendices contain a timeline, the companies of the King James translators, and the translators' rules.

Course Schedule

Dates are assigned according to the institute's calendar. "Recommended preparation" refers to the works listed in the syllabus.

Trimester One

Session	Date	Lesson and topic	Recommended preparation
1		Orientation and syllabus; Introduction: The Real Issue at Stake	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, introduction
2		Lesson 1: Revelation and the Giving of God's Words	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 1
3		Lesson 2: The Promised New Testament and the Written Word	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 43–47
4		Lesson 3: The Promises of Preservation	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 1
5		Lesson 4: Copies and Translations as Scripture	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 37–43
6		Lesson 5: The Pure Words and Jeremiah's Rolls	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 4
7		Lesson 6: Providence and the Settled English Bible	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 8
8		Lesson 7: The Attack upon God's Words	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 9
9		Lesson 8: How Scripture Reached Us	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 48–53; Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 5
10		Lesson 9: Antioch, Alexandria, and the Critical Text	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 53–64; Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 6
11		Lesson 10: Israel's Custody of the Old Testament	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 1–9
12		Lesson 11: The Hebrew Text before and after Christ	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 32–36
		Trimester One Examination (take-home), covering the Introduction and Lessons 1–11	Scripture memory 1–5

TRIMESTER TWO

Session	Date	Lesson and topic	Recommended preparation
13		Lesson 12: Greek Witnesses and the Hebrew Standard	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 10–17
14		Lesson 13: The Word Received, Read, and Kept	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 7
15		Lesson 14: Three Kinds of Witnesses	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 65–80
16		Lesson 15: The Great Codices Examined	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 81–92
17		Lesson 16: The Preparation and Completion of the English Bible	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 129–89; Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 3
18		Lesson 17: Translating the Words God Gave	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 4
19		Lesson 18: The Person of Christ and the Gospel	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 5
20		Lesson 19: Prayer, Accuracy, and the Gospel	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 5
21		Lesson 20: Understanding and Teaching the Words	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, introduction, sec. B
22		Lesson 21: General Questions about the King James Bible	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, introduction, secs. D–E
23		Lesson 22: Technical Questions and Concluding Confidence	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, chap. 31
		Final Examination; research paper and highlighted reading due	Scripture memory 6–10

The instructor may adjust the schedule for holidays and breaks. Where the calendar allows fewer sessions, the Introduction may be taught with Lesson 1.

Course Introduction

This course follows a single argument from the promises of Scripture to the English Bible. Each lesson builds on the one before it, and each step below is established from Scripture before the historical evidence is examined.

The Argument of the Course

1. God inspired His words, not merely His ideas.
2. God promised that those words would be preserved.
3. The Bible itself calls faithful copies and translations Scripture.
4. God committed the Old Testament to the Jews and preserved it in the Hebrew tradition.
5. God placed the New Testament in the life of believing churches, where it was read, copied, preached, and carried.
6. Those words passed from manuscripts into printed Hebrew and Greek texts and then into English.
7. Earlier English Bibles prepared the language, and the King James translators joined the preserved text to that tradition.
8. The result is the King James Bible, the preserved and purified Word of God in English.

Course Outline

The lessons follow the four parts of the course's argument and the order of their chapters. Record the class date beside each lesson.

INTRODUCTION

Introduction The Real Issue at Stake Date _____ 11

PART I: FAITH-BASED

INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

Lesson 1 Revelation and the Giving of God's Words Date _____ 14

Lesson 2 The Promised New Testament and the Written Word Date _____ 17

PRESERVATION: What God Promised to Continue

Lesson 3 The Promises of Preservation Date _____ 20

Lesson 4 Copies and Translations as Scripture Date _____ 23

PURIFICATION: How God Actively Refines the Bible

Lesson 5 The Pure Words and Jeremiah's Rolls Date _____ 26

Lesson 6 Providence and the Settled English Bible Date _____ 29

WAR ON WORDS

Lesson 7 The Attack upon God's Words Date _____ 32

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

Lesson 8 How Scripture Reached Us Date _____ 35

Lesson 9 Antioch, Alexandria, and the Critical Text Date _____ 39

PART II: THE OLD TESTAMENT

To the Jew Were Committed the Oracles

Lesson 10 Israel's Custody of the Old Testament Date _____ 43

Masoretic Text and the Dead Sea Scrolls

Lesson 11 The Hebrew Text before and after Christ Date _____ 46

Trimester Two begins

What the Septuagint Is (and Isn't)

Lesson 12 Greek Witnesses and the Hebrew Standard Date _____ 49

Course Outline (continued)

PART III: THE NEW TESTAMENT

The Text the Church Actually Used

Lesson 13 The Word Received, Read, and Kept Date _____ 52

Evidence: Manuscripts, Versions, and Fathers

Lesson 14 Three Kinds of Witnesses Date _____ 55

The Alexandrian Cluster (B, ℵ, A) in Context

Lesson 15 The Great Codices Examined Date _____ 58

FROM THE RECEIVED TEXT TO THE KING JAMES BIBLE

Lesson 16 The Preparation and Completion of the English Bible Date _____ 61

PART IV: OTHER ISSUES

Translation Practices: Dynamic vs. Formal Equivalence: Why Translation Philosophy Matters

Lesson 17 Translating the Words God Gave Date _____ 65

Doctrinal Issues (Why the "small" changes aren't small)

Lesson 18 The Person of Christ and the Gospel Date _____ 68

Lesson 19 Prayer, Accuracy, and the Gospel Date _____ 71

Ease of Reading

Lesson 20 Understanding and Teaching the Words Date _____ 74

Major FAQs

Lesson 21 General Questions about the King James Bible Date _____ 77

Lesson 22 Technical Questions and Concluding Confidence Date _____ 80

Conclusion: The Word of God Endureth Forever

Lesson 22 (concluded) 82

Trimester One: Introduction and Lessons 1–11. Trimester Two: Lessons 12–22. Appendices, glossary, and bibliography begin on page 84.

Introduction

INTRODUCTION The Real Issue at Stake

KEY TEXTS: Jer. 23:36; Eph. 6:10–17; Jude 3; Matt. 23:23; 1 Cor. 8:1; Jas. 1:22; 2 Tim. 2:24–25; Ps. 119

OBJECTIVES: *(1) State the central question of the course. (2) Describe the spirit in which the question is to be studied and discussed.*

1. The Real Issue at Stake

a. Discussion of Bible versions usually turns to preference: which translation reads most easily or sounds most natural. The prior questions are theological. Has God __preserved__ His words? Does a perfect Word of God exist today, and if so, where can it be found?

b. The ground of the debate has shifted. The contest once concerned what the Bible teaches; it now concerns where the Bible is to be ____found____. In the English-speaking world the Revised New Testament of 1881, translated from a newly constructed Greek text, marks the turning point.

> **JEREMIAH 23:36**
> *And the burden of the LORD shall ye mention no more: for every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.*

c. The question is one of final __authority__. Whatever a believer treats as the last court of appeal, whether the oldest manuscripts, a printed Greek text, the consensus of scholars, or the Bible in his hand, will govern every other judgment he makes.

2. The Believer's Weapon

a. Paul describes the believer as a soldier (2 Tim. 2:3–4) armed for a conflict with *spiritual wickedness in high places* (Eph. 6:12). Truth, righteousness, the gospel, faith, and salvation are all supplied by the Word of God, and the Word is itself his one offensive weapon.[1]

> **EPHESIANS 6:17**
> *And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:*

[1] Jasper James Ray, *God Wrote Only One Bible* (Junction City, OR: Eye Opener Publishers, 1955).

b. Jude therefore exhorts believers to *earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered unto the saints* (Jude 3). Contending requires knowing what was delivered and where it may be found.

3. The Word Must Be Believed and Obeyed

a. Knowledge of this subject must not displace *the weightier matters of the law, judgment, mercy, and faith* (Matt. 23:23). Knowledge alone *puffeth up*, while charity ___edifieth___ (1 Cor. 8:1).

> **JAMES 1:22**
> *But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.*

b. The servant of the Lord must be *gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient* (2 Tim. 2:24). A faulty reading does not become true because a sincere believer reads it, and a sincere believer does not become an enemy because he has not yet studied the question. Evaluating a Bible is distinct from ___judging___ the person who holds it.

4. Marks of Love for the Word (Psalm 119)

a. The course concerns the heart as well as the evidence. Psalm 119 supplies tests by which a believer may examine his own love for the Word of God.

Mark	Text
What he hates: *I hate every false way*	Ps. 119:104, 128, 163
What occupies his mind: *it is my meditation all the day*	Ps. 119:97
What gives him joy: *as one that findeth great spoil*	Ps. 119:162
What he obeys: *My soul hath kept thy testimonies*	Ps. 119:167
What cannot offend him: *nothing shall offend them*	Ps. 119:165

b. The purpose of the course is therefore practical: to know what God has said, to believe it, to obey it, and to place it in the hands of ___others___.

> **PSALM 119:97**
> *O how love I thy law! it is my meditation all the day.*

REVIEW

Why must the question *Where is the Word of God?* be settled before the question *What does it teach?* can be answered with confidence?

PART I: FAITH-BASED

INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

LESSON 1 Revelation and the Giving of God's Words

KEY TEXTS: Deut. 29:29; Ps. 19:1–6; Rom. 1:20; Heb. 1:1–2; 2 Tim. 3:16–17; 2 Pet. 1:21; Matt. 4:4

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Distinguish general revelation, special revelation, and inspiration. (2) Explain from Scripture the meaning of verbal, plenary inspiration.*

1. Defining Revelation

a. Revelation is God's __uncovering__ of what was hidden, so that it may be seen for what it is. The Hebrew verb *galah* is rendered in the KJV *uncovered* (Gen. 9:21), *appeared* (Gen. 35:7), *discovered* (Exod. 20:26), *opened* (Num. 22:31), *published* (Esth. 8:13), and *disclose* (Isa. 26:21).

> **DEUTERONOMY 29:29**
> *The secret things belong unto the LORD our God: but those things which are revealed belong unto us and to our children for ever, that we may do all the words of this law.*

b. The first mention sets the principle: what God reveals belongs to His people and to their children *for ever*, and it is given in order to be obeyed.

2. General Revelation

a. ___General___ revelation is the knowledge of God given to all men through creation and conscience (Ps. 19:1–6; Rom. 1:20). It declares His existence, power, and glory, and it leaves men without excuse. Because both creation and the human mind are marred by sin (Gen. 3:17; Rom. 8:22), it cannot reveal the way of salvation.

3. Special Revelation

a. ___Special___ revelation is God's direct disclosure of Himself and His will. He spoke *at sundry times and in divers manners*:

Means	Example
Dreams	Joseph (Gen. 37:5–10)
Visions	Daniel (Dan. 8:1)
The Urim and Thummim	The high priest (Exod. 28:30)
An audible voice	Samuel (1 Sam. 3:10)
An animal	Balaam's ass (Num. 22:28)
Prophets and apostles	2 Pet. 1:21; Eph. 3:5

> **HEBREWS 1:1–2**
> *1 God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets, 2 Hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son, whom he hath appointed heir of all things, by whom also he made the worlds;*

b. The crown of special revelation is the _____Son_____ (John 1:14; 14:9). Its written and completed form is the Scripture, which alone now carries God's revelation to every generation.

4. The Meaning of Inspiration

a. The Greek adjective in 2 Timothy 3:16, θεόπνευστος (*theopneustos*), means __God-breathed__.[2] Inspiration identifies God as the source of Scripture; it describes the product He breathed out, not a heightened human insight.

> **2 TIMOTHY 3:16–17**
> *16 All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: 17 That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.*

b. In Scripture the breath of God imparts life: man became a living soul (Gen. 2:7), dry bones lived (Ezek. 37:9–10), and *the inspiration of the Almighty giveth them understanding* (Job 32:8). The written Word carries the same divine life and authority.

> **2 PETER 1:21**
> *For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.*

c. The prophets spoke as they were moved, or borne along, by the __Holy Ghost__. Inspiration occurred once, when they first wrote; later copyists and translators were not inspired in this sense.

[2] Joseph Henry Thayer, *A Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament* (New York: American Book Company, 1889), s.v. "θεόπνευστος."

5. Inspiration Extends to the Words

a. David testified, *The Spirit of the LORD spake by me, and his word was in my tongue* (2 Sam. 23:2), and Christ built an argument on one word of Psalm 110:1 (Matt. 22:43–45).

b. Because man lives *by every word* of God (Matt. 4:4), inspiration is ___verbal___, reaching the words and their smallest marks (Matt. 5:18). Because *all scripture* is given by inspiration, it is ___plenary___. Scripture is therefore inerrant and infallible, for God cannot lie (Titus 1:2).

6. The Divine Order

Term	Meaning	Key text
Revelation	God makes truth known	Deut. 29:29
Inspiration	God gives that truth in written words	2 Tim. 3:16
Illumination	The Spirit enables the believer to understand it	1 Cor. 2:12
Preservation	God keeps His words intact	Ps. 12:6–7
Propagation	God's people carry the words to the world	Matt. 28:19–20

a. A believer may affirm preservation without propagating the Word, but no one can propagate it with conviction unless he knows it has been __preserved__ without error.

REVIEW

Explain the difference between saying the Bible *contains* God's message and saying it *is* God's words. Which does Matthew 4:4 require?

INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

LESSON 2 The Promised New Testament and the Written Word

KEY TEXTS: John 14:26; 16:12–13; Amos 8:11–12; Col. 2:6–7; Rom. 10:17; John 1:1, 14; 5:39–40; 12:48

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Show from Christ's promises that the New Testament is the Spirit-given witness to Him. (2) Explain the relationship between the Incarnate Word and the written Word.*

1. Christ Promised the New Testament Before It Was Written

a. Before the crucifixion Christ promised that the Holy Ghost would bring His teaching to the apostles' __remembrance__. The Gospels rest on that provision, not on the unaided memory of aging men.

> **JOHN 14:26**
> *But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.*

b. The Spirit would also testify of Christ through the apostles (John 15:26–27), guide them *into all truth*, and show them *things to come* (16:13), anticipating the Gospels, Acts, the Epistles, and Revelation.

2. Where Is the Perfect Word Today?

a. Many doctrinal statements affirm inerrancy only "in the original autographs." Pressed further, they place the perfect Word either in __originals__ that perished long ago and were never gathered into one volume, or collectively among thousands of witnesses, none of which is identified as complete and correct. Neither answer points the believer to a Bible he can hold (cf. Amos 8:11–12).

3. Faith-Based?

a. The position of this course is that the perfect, inerrant, and plenary Word of God exists today in a book that can be read and believed. The argument begins with the __promises__ and principles of Scripture and interprets history in their light.

> **COLOSSIANS 2:6–7**
> *6 As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him: 7 Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, as ye have been taught, abounding therein with thanksgiving.*

b. The Christian life begins and continues by ____faith____; *without faith it is impossible to please him* (Heb. 11:6). The believer who received Christ by faith walks in Him by faith, including in his view of Scripture.

> **ROMANS 10:17**
> *So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.*

c. Faith comes by ___hearing___ the word of God. Faith is not credulity; it is trust in what God has said, and it governs how the believer weighs evidence, as the Bereans tested preaching by the Scriptures (Acts 17:11).

4. The Incarnate Word and the Inscripturated Word

> **JOHN 1:1**
> *In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.*

a. *The Word was made flesh* (John 1:14). Jesus Christ is the __Incarnate__ Word, the eternal Son who took human nature while remaining fully God (Rev. 19:13).

b. The Bible is the __inscripturated__ Word, God's revelation committed to writing through prophets and apostles. The term does not make paper or ink divine; it describes God's words placed in written form.

c. The two must be distinguished, for Christ is a divine Person and Scripture is not; yet they cannot be separated in source, truth, or authority. Christ gave the disciples the words the Father gave Him (John 17:8), and He said, *thy word is truth* (John 17:17). God has *magnified* His word *above all* His name (Ps. 138:2).

5. The Scriptures Testify of Christ

> **JOHN 5:39–40**
> *39 Search the scriptures; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which testify of me. 40 And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life.*

a. The Jews searched the Scriptures yet refused the One of whom they ___testify___. After His resurrection Christ expounded *in all the scriptures the things concerning himself* (Luke 24:27).

6. Christ Judges by His Words

> **JOHN 12:48**
> *He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day.*

a. Two errors must be avoided: claiming to honor Christ while doubting or correcting His ___written___ Word, and claiming to honor the Book while refusing to come to Christ and obey Him.

b. God speaks through His Word *to withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man,* and to keep back *his soul from the pit* (Job 33:14–18). A perfect Christ gave a perfect Word for that saving purpose.

REVIEW

How does the relationship between Christ and Scripture bear on the question of whether God would allow His written Word to be lost?

PRESERVATION: What God Promised to Continue

LESSON 3 The Promises of Preservation

KEY TEXTS: Ps. 12:6–7; Ps. 119:89, 152, 160; Isa. 40:8; 59:21; Matt. 5:18; 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:23–25

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Define preservation and state its biblical basis. (2) Distinguish the preservation of words from the survival of materials.*

1. The Basic Logic of Preservation

a. If God had not preserved His words, they would in time have eroded away, and men would be left with their own opinions. Believers would lack the confidence to proclaim His warnings and promises, and no one could be sure of the way back to the Creator.

b. To preserve is to keep or _____save_____ from corruption. Applied to Scripture, preservation is God's supernatural securing and transmission of every inspired word.

2. The Promises of Preservation

> **PSALM 12:6–7**
> 6 *The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.* 7 *Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

a. The object of the promise is the ____words_____ of the LORD, and its duration is ___for ever___.

b. The Old Testament repeats the promise. God's word is *settled in heaven* (Ps. 119:89); His testimonies are *founded … for ever* (119:152); His word shall *stand for ever* (Isa. 40:8). Isaiah 59:21 extends the covenant to the believer's *seed's seed*, that is, to succeeding __generations__.

> **MATTHEW 24:35**
> *Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.*

c. Christ's words shall not __pass away__. His guarantee reaches the jot, the smallest Hebrew letter, and the tittle, the small stroke that distinguishes one letter from another (Matt. 5:18; Luke 16:17). *The scripture cannot be broken* (John 10:35).

d. See also Deut. 7:9; 1 Chron. 16:15; Ps. 33:11; 100:5; 105:8; 117:2; 119:111, 160; Eccl. 3:14; Matt. 5:17–18; Luke 21:33; 1 Pet. 1:23–25.

e. Peter applies Isaiah 40:8 to the gospel his readers heard: *the word of the Lord endureth for ever. And this is the word which by the gospel is preached unto you* (1 Pet. 1:25). Preservation concerns the Word God's people actually possess.

> "Building a road across a vast wilderness (inspiration) would be much more difficult than patching the holes (preservation) in that same road after it has been built. But if the road isn't preserved it will soon deteriorate."[3]

3. A Historic Baptist Confession of Preservation

a. The Second London Baptist Confession (1689) states that the Hebrew Old Testament and Greek New Testament, "being immediately inspired by God, and by his singular care and providence kept _____pure_____ in all ages, are therefore authentic."[4]

b. The same paragraph directs that Scripture be translated into the __common language__ of every nation. The Westminster Confession (1646) and the Savoy Declaration (1658) use nearly identical words; the doctrine was shared across the Reformed confessions.

4. God Preserved His Words, Not the Material

a. The promise attaches to the words, not to the sheets that carried them. *The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away* (1 Pet. 1:24), and so do papyrus and parchment. A manuscript may decay while its text continues in faithful ___copies___.

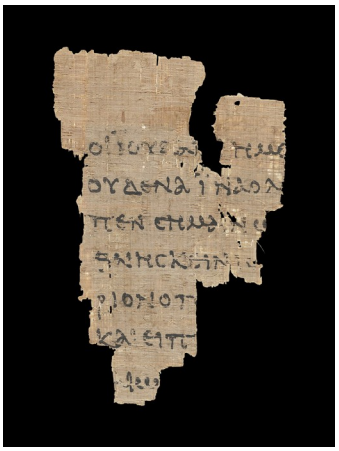


Figure 1. Papyrus P52 (John Rylands Library, Greek P 457), recto, preserving parts of John 18:31–33. The horizontal fibers of the papyrus sheet are visible.

[3] Samuel C. Gipp, *Gipp's Understandable History of the Bible* (Miamitown, OH: Day Star Publishing, 2004), 20, 30.

[4] The Second London Baptist Confession of Faith (1689), chap. 1, para. 8, "Of the Holy Scriptures."

b. ___Papyrus___ was made from strips of the pith of the papyrus plant laid in two layers at right angles, pressed, and dried.[5] Parchment was untanned skin of sheep, goats, or calves prepared for writing; vellum is a fine grade (cf. 2 Tim. 4:13).[6]

5. The Materials of Transmission

Material or instrument	Description	Scripture
Stone	Tables engraved by God; plastered stones written on	Exod. 34:1; Deut. 27:2–3
Table (tablet)	A writing board or tablet	Isa. 30:8; Hab. 2:2; Luke 1:63
Roll (scroll)	Sheets joined and rolled; *the volume of the book*	Jer. 36:2; Ezek. 2:9; Heb. 10:7
Book (codex)	Leaves folded and bound on one side	2 Tim. 4:13 (*the books*)
Paper (papyrus)	Sheets made from the papyrus plant	2 John 12
Parchments	Prepared animal skin	2 Tim. 4:13
Iron pen (stylus)	A pointed tool that cuts letters	Job 19:24; Jer. 17:1
Pen and ink	A reed pen laying ink of soot and gum	Jer. 36:18; 3 John 13

a. Material and format are separate questions. The age of a surviving sheet does not settle the age or truth of the ___readings___ it carries.

REVIEW

Why can the destruction of a writing surface be distinguished from the loss of the words written on it? Support your answer from 1 Peter 1:24–25.

[5] Rebecca Capua, "Papyrus-Making in Egypt," *Heilbrunn Timeline of Art History*, Metropolitan Museum of Art, March 2015, https://www.metmuseum.org/essays/papyrus-making-in-egypt.

[6] Frederic G. Kenyon, *Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament*, 2nd ed. (London: Macmillan, 1912), 38–39, 47, 49, 124–25.

PRESERVATION: What God Promised to Continue

LESSON 4 Copies and Translations as Scripture

KEY TEXTS: Deut. 17:18–19; 2 Kings 22:8–13; Luke 4:17–21; Acts 8:28–35; 17:11; 2 Tim. 3:15; Acts 2:6–11; Col. 1:13

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Demonstrate from Scripture that faithful copies are called Scripture. (2) Show that Scripture itself records and approves translation.*

1. Copies as Scripture

a. Scripture never restricts its authority to the autographs. God's people read, obeyed, and were judged by ____copies____.

> **DEUTERONOMY 17:18–19**
> 18 *And it shall be, when he sitteth upon the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write him a copy of this law in a book out of that which is before the priests the Levites:* 19 *And it shall be with him, and he shall read therein all the days of his life: that he may learn to fear the LORD his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them:*

b. Israel's king was to write a copy of the law from the text kept by the Levites and read it *all the days of his life*. God's plan has always been to pass His words along as a copy of a ____copy____, carrying the authority of the law itself.

c. When Hilkiah found *the book of the law*, Josiah rent his clothes because the nation had not obeyed *the words of this book* (2 Kings 22:8–13). Ezra held *the law of thy God which is in thine hand* (Ezra 7:14), and the Levites read it and gave the ____sense____ (Neh. 8:8).

d. At Nazareth Christ read from *the book of the prophet Esaias*, a scroll copied centuries after Isaiah, and declared, *This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears* (Luke 4:17–21). He called the copy in His hand __scripture__.

e. The Ethiopian read Isaiah, and Philip *began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus* (Acts 8:35). The Bereans *searched the scriptures daily* to test Paul's preaching (Acts 17:11).

> **2 TIMOTHY 3:15**
> *And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus.*

f. Timothy had known the Scriptures __from a child__. Paul calls the copies in his home *holy scriptures* able to make him wise unto salvation, and in the next verse says that *all scripture is given by inspiration of God*.

2. Translations Can Still Be Scripture

a. At Pentecost each hearer heard *in our tongues the wonderful works of God* (Acts 2:11). God had foretold that He would speak to His people *with men of other tongues* (Isa. 28:11; 1 Cor. 14:21), and the everlasting gospel is for *every nation, and kindred, and tongue* (Rev. 14:6). The command to *teach all nations* (Matt. 28:19) requires __translation__.

Account	Spoken in	Recorded in Scripture in
Joseph and his brethren, through an interpreter (Gen. 42:23)	Egyptian	Hebrew
Paul's defense at Jerusalem (Acts 21:40–22:21)	Hebrew	Greek
Christ's words to Saul (Acts 26:14)	Hebrew	Greek
Talitha cumi (Mark 5:41)	Aramaic	Greek, with translation

b. In each case no record survives in the language first spoken. The words God preserved in __translation__ are Scripture, and Ezra 4:8–6:18 and Daniel 2:4–7:28 were themselves written in Aramaic.

3. A Biblical Picture of Translation

a. In the King James Bible, *translate* describes a God-ordained transfer into a better condition: the kingdom from Saul's house to David (2 Sam. 3:10), the believer from darkness into the kingdom of God's dear Son, and Enoch from earth into God's presence (Heb. 11:5).

> **Colossians 1:13**
> *Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son:*

b. Translation under God's hand therefore need not mean __degradation__. Words do not become weaker merely because they cross into another language.

c. This does not mean every translation is pure. It establishes that a _____pure_____ translation is possible and prepares for the question of which text and which translation God has used to keep His words.

REVIEW

List three passages in which a copy of Scripture is treated as Scripture. What does each imply about the claim that only the autographs were inspired?

PURIFICATION: How God Actively Refines the Bible

LESSON 5 The Pure Words and Jeremiah's Rolls

Key texts: Ps. 12:6–7; Prov. 30:5–6; Ps. 18:30; Jer. 36:1–32

Objectives: *(1) Define purification and distinguish it from inspiration and preservation. (2) Explain the lesson of Jeremiah's two rolls.*

Most Christians affirm inspiration, fewer affirm preservation, and fewer still affirm purification. Yet Scripture speaks of the __purifying__ of God's words as plainly as it speaks of the other two.

1. The Pure Words

> **Psalm 12:6**
> *The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.*

a. The words of the LORD are compared to silver *purified seven times*. In Scripture ___seven___ marks completeness, so the figure describes refining carried to its end: a settled form that needs no further refining.

> **Proverbs 30:5–6**
> 5 *Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him.* 6 *Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.*

b. Every word of God is ___pure___, and the warning against adding to His words follows at once. Psalm 18:30 adds that *the word of the LORD is tried*, tested as metal is tested.

2. Keeping the Three Terms Separate

a. __Inspiration__ is God's initial giving of His words through the prophets and apostles.

b. __Preservation__ is His keeping of those words through history, so that they do not pass away.

c. __Purification__ is His providential work of bringing the preserved words through copying, printing, translation, comparison, and reception until they stand in a settled form. It does not make later copyists or translators prophets, and it does not produce new revelation.

d. The history of the English Bible illustrates the process. Seven major English Bibles preceded the King James: Wycliffe (1382), Tyndale (1525–26), Coverdale (1535), Matthew's (1537), the Great Bible (1539), Geneva (1560), and the Bishops' (1568). Many have noted the parallel with the *seven times* of Psalm 12:6.

> **PSALM 18:30**
> *As for God, his way is perfect: the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him.*

3. Case Study: Jeremiah's Rolls

a. The original was written. Baruch wrote *from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the LORD … upon a roll of a book* (Jer. 36:4).

b. The original was destroyed. Jehoiakim cut the roll with a penknife and burned it *until all the roll was consumed* (36:23).

> **JEREMIAH 36:32**
> *Then took Jeremiah another roll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah; who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire: and there were added besides unto them many like words.*

c. The second roll contained *all the former words* and *many like words* besides. It was not less than the first but ___greater___. Had only the first roll survived, it would have lacked words God intended His people to have.

d. The added words were new prophetic revelation, which later scribes and translators do not receive. The lesson for this course is that God did not make the autograph an object of veneration; He preserved His words in a ____second____ roll.

REVIEW

Why did God not simply preserve Jeremiah's first roll? What does the second roll teach about the place of the "original" document?

PURIFICATION: How God Actively Refines the Bible

LESSON 6 Providence and the Settled English Bible

KEY TEXTS: Jer. 36:27–32; Ps. 12:6–7; Ps. 119:140; 1 John 5:7; Jer. 32:27

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Answer the charge of "double inspiration." (2) State the question of final authority and its alternatives.*

1. "Double Inspiration"?

a. Critics sometimes say that defenders of the King James Bible teach __double inspiration__, as though God breathed out Scripture a second time in 1611. The charge misstates the position.

b. Inspiration is by definition God's initial act of breathing out His words, and it occurred _____once_____, in the originals. The King James Bible is not newly inspired; it consists of inspired words that God has preserved and purified.

c. What the charge overlooks is the biblical category of purification. God can refine through __providence__ what He first gave by inspiration, as the history of Jeremiah's second roll shows.

> **PSALM 119:140**
> *Thy word is very pure: therefore thy servant loveth it.*

d. Scripture itself distinguishes the acts. God spoke *at sundry times and in divers manners* by the prophets (Heb. 1:1); He also promised to keep what He had spoken (Ps. 12:7). Keeping is not a second speaking.

2. Purification and Providence in the King James Bible

a. Edward Hills argued that the Latin-speaking church preserved a few genuine readings that had become rare in Greek copies. He described the Textus Receptus as a further step in the providential __preservation__ of the New Testament:

> "In it the few errors of any consequence occurring in the Traditional Greek Text were corrected by the providence of God operating through the usage of the Latin speaking Church of Western Europe."[7]

[7] Edward F. Hills, *The King James Version Defended: A Christian View of the New Testament Manuscripts*, 5th ed. (Des Moines, IA: Christian Research Press, 2006), 139.

b. The clearest example is 1 John 5:7. Absent from most late Greek copies, the verse was retained in the ____Latin____ tradition, and Cyprian (c. A.D. 250) cites its closing words, *and these three are one*.[8] Erasmus omitted it in 1516 and 1519 and included it in his ____third____ edition of 1522.

> **1 John 5:7**
> *For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.*

3. The Choice: Purification or Degradation

a. The King James translators began their work in 1604 with the Received Greek Text of Erasmus, Stephanus, and Beza and with the English Bibles from Wycliffe to Geneva. The result is understood here as the fruit of purification, both textual and __linguistic__.

b. Every step required decisions: Erasmus with 1 John 5:7, the translators with variant readings, believers with the manuscripts they received. The question beneath all of them is whether God is still at work in the ___process___.

c. If He is, a perfect Bible exists today, complete to the jot and tittle. If He is not, the believer holds at best a fallible approximation of lost originals. *If the foundations be destroyed, what can the righteous do?* (Ps. 11:3).

> **Psalm 12:7**
> *Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

4. Preservation versus Inspiration: The Question of Final Authority

a. Many evangelical leaders hold that the originals were perfect but that every copy and translation is imperfect. The position is widely assumed, yet no scriptural proof is offered for it.

Possible final authority	Difficulty or answer
The "oldest and best" Greek and Hebrew manuscripts	They disagree with one another and change with each discovery.
The printed Masoretic and Received texts	Their printed editions differ slightly among themselves.
The King James Bible	A present, complete Book that can be read, preached, and obeyed.

[8] Cyprian, *De Unitate Ecclesiae* 6. Cyprian writes, "The Lord says, 'I and the Father are one'; and again it is written of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, 'And these three are one.'"

> **JEREMIAH 32:27**
> *Behold, I am the LORD, the God of all flesh: is there any thing too hard for me?*

b. If God could overcome human weakness in giving the originals and preserve them in Hebrew and Greek, He is able to do the same in a __translation__. The believer who holds that God has kept His words can at least produce the Book he claims to believe.

REVIEW

Explain why purification is not "double inspiration." Use Jeremiah 36 in your answer.

WAR ON WORDS

LESSON 7 The Attack upon God's Words

Key texts: Gen. 2:16–17; 3:1–6, 16; Deut. 4:2; Prov. 30:6; Rev. 22:18–19; 2 Cor. 2:17; 11:3–4; Isa. 14:14

Objectives: *(1) Trace the satanic pattern of attack on God's words from Genesis 3. (2) Recognize the counterfeits Satan offers in place of the truth.*

God is committed to purifying His words; the devil is committed to corrupting them. A student who ignores this conflict will misread the history of the text, because Scripture presents God's Word as a target of spiritual ___warfare___.

1. God's Repeated Warnings

a. God forbids adding to or __taking from__ His words at the beginning of the canon (Deut. 4:2), in its middle (Prov. 30:6), and at its end (Rev. 22:18–19).

> **Revelation 22:19**
> *And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.*

2. False Letters in the Early Church

a. While the New Testament was still being written, Paul warned the Thessalonians not to be shaken *by letter as from us* (2 Thess. 2:2) and marked every genuine epistle with his own __signature__ (3:17). He also warned of *many, which corrupt the word of God* (2 Cor. 2:17).

3. The Devil's First Appearance

> **Genesis 3:1**
> *Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he said unto the woman, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?*

a. The serpent's first words ___question___ God's word: *Yea, hath God said?* The same question lies at the heart of modern textual doubt: what did God actually say, and can it be known?

b. He then __contradicts__ it. God had not forbidden *every tree of the garden*; He had forbidden one (Gen. 2:16–17).

c. Finally he ___changes___ it: *Ye shall not surely die* (3:4) reverses *thou shalt surely die*.

> **GENESIS 2:16–17**
> *16 And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat: 17 But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.*

d. Eve also added to the word, saying *neither shall ye touch it* (3:3). Under pressure from a corrupted word, even the defender of the word misquoted it.

4. The Pattern and the Continuing Attack

a. In a few verses the method is complete: question the word, contradict it, change it. The Fall followed an attack on the ____word____ of God, and the method has not changed.

b. The same tactic appears at the temptation of Christ. Satan quoted Psalm 91:11–12 but omitted the words *to keep thee in all thy ways* (Matt. 4:6). Christ answered, *It is written again* (Matt. 4:7).

5. Example: Genesis 3:16

> **GENESIS 3:16**
> *Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children; and thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee.*

a. The English Standard Version (2016) reads, "Your desire shall be contrary to your husband."[9] The KJV directs the woman's desire ____to____ her husband; the ESV sets it against him. The two statements are opposites.

6. Satan the Counterfeiter

a. Satan's ambition is to be *like the most High* (Isa. 14:14). He therefore imitates what God has given, offering a plurality in place of each divine unity.

> **2 CORINTHIANS 11:4**
> *For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached, or if ye receive another spirit, which ye have not received, or another gospel, which ye have not accepted, ye might well bear with him.*

[9] English Standard Version (Wheaton, IL: Crossway, 2016), Gen. 3:16; 1 Tim. 3:16; John 1:18.

God's provision	Satan's counterfeit
One God (1 Cor. 8:6)	Many "gods"
One Christ	Many false christs (Matt. 24:24)
One Spirit (Eph. 4:4)	*another spirit* (2 Cor. 11:4)
One gospel	*another gospel* (Gal. 1:6–8)
One body (Eph. 4:4)	Many religions and sects
One Bible	Many "bibles"

b. A counterfeit is recognized by comparison with the ___genuine___. The believer who knows the true Word can discern its imitations.

REVIEW

Identify the three steps of the serpent's method in Genesis 3:1–5. Where do you see the same pattern in modern discussion of the Bible?

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

LESSON 8 How Scripture Reached Us

Key texts: Jer. 36:28; Col. 4:16; 2 Pet. 3:15–16; Mark 12:37

Objectives: *(1) Trace the stages from autograph to English translation. (2) Identify a manuscript by its material, format, script, and text-type.*

1. How Scripture Reached Us

a. The autographs, the documents first written by the prophets and apostles, are no longer known to exist. Their words were copied by hand in __manuscripts__, handwritten copies of all or part of a biblical book.

b. Hand copying produced __textual variants__: differences of spelling, word order, omission, addition, or substitution. Most concern spelling or word order; some involve whole passages, such as Mark 16:9–20 and 1 John 5:7.

c. Manuscripts that repeatedly share readings form a textual tradition, or __text-type__. The Byzantine text is found in the majority of surviving Greek manuscripts; the Alexandrian text is associated with manuscripts preserved in Egypt. Neither label means that every manuscript in the group is identical.

d. The course of transmission may be summarized in six stages:

Original writings → handwritten manuscripts → textual variants → textual traditions → printed Hebrew and Greek texts → English translations

2. Reading a Manuscript: Handwriting

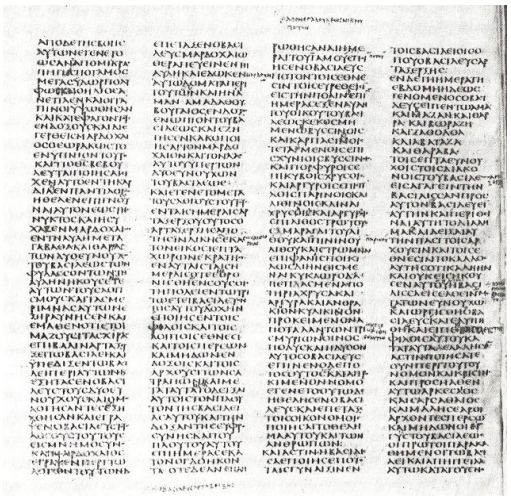


Figure 2. Majuscule (uncial) hand: Codex Sinaiticus, fourth century.

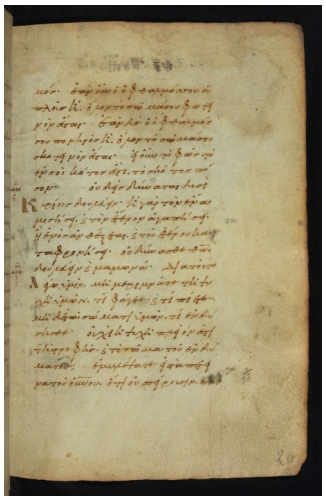


Figure 3. Minuscule hand: Walters Art Museum W.523, tenth century.

a. __Majuscules__, or uncials, are written in separate capital letters. *Uncial* comes from the Latin *uncia*, a twelfth part or inch, describing letters about an inch high. The great codices of the fourth and fifth centuries are majuscules. Minuscules, in a smaller joined hand, predominate from the ninth century onward.[10]

b. Early scribes wrote without spaces between words (*scriptio continua*). In English, GODISNOWHERE could be read "God is now here" or "God is nowhere"; context and a received tradition of reading decide.

3. The Vocabulary of Manuscripts

Term	Meaning
Scribe; scriptorium	A professional copyist; the room set apart for copying
Exemplar	The manuscript from which a copy is made
Chirography	The handwriting of a scribe or period, used to date a manuscript
Palimpsest	A manuscript scraped and written over, such as Codex Ephraemi Rescriptus (C)
Koine	The common Greek of the first century, the language of the New Testament
Sigla	Catalogue symbols: P52 (papyri), ℵ = 01 and B = 03 (majuscules), 61 (minuscules), ℓ (lectionaries)

a. __Lectionaries__ are service books arranging Scripture for public reading. The

[10] Kenyon, *Handbook*, 124–25.

synaxaria begin the church year at Easter, the *menologia* on September 1; Kurt Aland counted 2,143 lectionary manuscripts.[11]

b. Material, format, script, and text-type answer four different __questions__ about a manuscript. A papyrus codex may be written in a majuscule hand and carry any text-type.

4. From Manuscripts to Printed Greek Texts

a. Erasmus published the first Greek New Testament in 1516 and revised it in 1519, 1522, 1527, and 1535. Stephanus issued editions in 1546, 1549, 1550, and 1551; Beza's editions of 1588–89 and 1598 were used extensively by the King James translators.[12]

b. The name __Textus Receptus__ derives from the preface of the Elzevir edition of 1633: *Textum ergo habes, nunc ab omnibus receptum* ("You have therefore the text now received by all").[13]

c. The Byzantine Text is a manuscript tradition; the Majority Text denotes the readings of most surviving manuscripts; the Textus Receptus is the family of printed editions from Erasmus to the Elzevirs. Scrivener's Greek text of 1881 reconstructs the Greek underlying the KJV; it was not the translators' source.[14]

d. Modern critical editions, NA28 and UBS5, print essentially the same __eclectic__ text, which gives greater weight to Alexandrian witnesses.

[11] Jack Moorman, *Forever Settled: A Survey of the Documents and History of the Bible* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 1985), 49.

[12] Bruce M. Metzger and Bart D. Ehrman, *The Text of the New Testament: Its Transmission, Corruption, and Restoration*, 4th ed. (New York: Oxford University Press, 2005), 142–52.

[13] J. K. Elliott, "'Novum Testamentum editum est': The Five-Hundredth Anniversary of Erasmus's New Testament," *The Bible Translator* 67, no. 1 (2016): 24, https://doi.org/10.1177/2051677016628242.

[14] F. H. A. Scrivener, ed., *The New Testament in the Original Greek according to the Text Followed in the Authorised Version, Together with the Variations Adopted in the Revised Version* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1881), vii–xii, 648–56.

REVIEW

Distinguish a manuscript, a text-type, a printed edition, and a translation. Where does the Textus Receptus belong?

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

LESSON 9 Antioch, Alexandria, and the Critical Text

KEY TEXTS: Acts 11:19–26; 13:1–3; 6:9; 18:24–26; Gen. 12:10–20; Exod. 20:2; Mark 12:37

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Contrast the naturalistic and faith-based methods of textual criticism. (2) Evaluate the canons and theories used to set aside the Byzantine text.*

1. Two Starting Points: Preservation or Reconstruction

a. The __naturalistic__ method treats the New Testament by the rules applied to any ancient book. It begins with the surviving manuscripts, reconstructs what the authors most probably wrote, and treats no received text as final.

b. Edward Hills contrasted it with the "consistently Christian" method, which interprets the same evidence in accordance with the doctrines of inspiration and providential __preservation__.[15] That method does not reject manuscripts, versions, or fathers; it declines to interpret them apart from Scripture.

c. One method asks which reading is most probable by the canons of criticism; the other asks which reading fits God's promises and the historical ____usage____ of His people.

> **1 CORINTHIANS 2:14**
> *But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him: neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned.*

2. The Canons of Textual Criticism

Canon	Claim	Response
Lectio brevior potior	The shorter reading is preferred, since scribes tended to add.	Scribes also omitted, often by accident (see Royse, below).
Lectio difficilior potior	The harder reading is preferred, since scribes tended to simplify.	A copying error also makes a reading "harder."
Manuscripts are weighed, not counted	Agreement of many late copies counts as one witness.	Hort conceded that a majority normally reflects a majority of ancestors.[16]

[15] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, vii–viii.

[16] Brooke Foss Westcott and Fenton John Anthony Hort, *The New Testament in the Original Greek*, vol. 2, *Introduction and Appendix* (London: Macmillan, 1881), 45.

a. The course notes set against these canons the "canons of the common man." The Received Text reads plainly, and *the common people heard him gladly* (Mark 12:37). It is full and complete, without broken sentences. Its copies are late because they were _____used_____ and worn out, while unused copies survived.

3. Antioch: The Line of Preservation

a. At Antioch the disciples were first called Christians (Acts 11:26), and from Antioch the Holy Ghost sent Paul and Barnabas on the first missionary journey (Acts 13:1–3). Scripture presents that church as a model of teaching, missions, and __faithfulness__; later heresies in the region do not overturn that testimony.

b. The Byzantine text, associated with this region and the Greek-speaking churches, is found in roughly 80 to 95 percent of surviving Greek manuscripts and stands behind the Textus Receptus.[17]

4. Alexandria: The Line of Corruption

a. Egypt's first appearance in Scripture is Abraham's compromise (Gen. 12:10–20); thereafter it is *the house of bondage* (Exod. 20:2). Alexandrians disputed with Stephen (Acts 6:9), and Apollos of Alexandria needed the way of God expounded *more perfectly* (Acts 18:24–26).

b. The city's best-known Christian scholar, ____Origen____ (c. 184–254), allegorized Scripture and taught the pre-existence of souls.[18] Philip Schaff judged that "the predilection of Origen for Plato misled him into many grand and fascinating errors."[19]

5. The Revision of 1881

a. In 1870 the Convocation of Canterbury appointed a committee to revise the Authorized Version. Its Revised New Testament (1881) followed a new Greek text prepared by Brooke Foss Westcott and Fenton John Anthony _____Hort_____, published the same year; the American Standard Version (1901) followed.

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[17] Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text IV* (Brasília: Wilbur N. Pickering, 2014), 114; Zane C. Hodges and Arthur L. Farstad, eds., *The Greek New Testament According to the Majority Text*, 2nd ed. (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1985), v–vi.

[18] Origen, *De Principiis*, I.6.1–3, II.3.3, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 4, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Grand Rapids: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 2006), 259–61, 273; Philip Schaff, *History of the Christian Church*, vol. 2, *Ante-Nicene Christianity, A.D. 100–325* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1910), 791.

[19] Philip Schaff, *History of the Christian Church*, vol. 2, *Ante-Nicene Christianity, A.D. 100–325* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1910), 791.

b. Hort's attitude was fixed early. In 1851, at age twenty-three, he wrote of having "dragged on with the villainous Textus Receptus."[20] Their correspondence shows sympathy for Mariolatry: Hort wrote that "Mary-worship and 'Jesus'-worship have very much in common."[21]

c. Westcott helped found a Cambridge society, the "Ghostlie Guild" (1851), for the investigation of apparitions.[22] The men who set aside the Received Text did not approach Scripture from a __faith-based__ starting point.

d. Their text rested chiefly on B and ℵ. The Revised Version was received coolly by ordinary believers; the flood of later versions came with the marketing of the twentieth century.

6. "Reasoned Eclecticism" and Why the Issue Still Matters

a. Modern editors weigh external and internal evidence for each variant. Kurt and Barbara Aland nonetheless place most Byzantine manuscripts in Category V, of little value for establishing the original text.[23] Gregory Lanier found ____98.5____ percent agreement between NA28/ECM and Westcott and Hort's text of 1881 in sampled passages.[24]

7. Theories Used to Dismiss the Byzantine Text

a. *Prefer the shorter reading.* James Royse found that the scribes of six major early papyri ___omitted___ material more often than they added it.[25]

b. *Conflation.* Harry Sturz showed that supposed conflations are not confined to Byzantine manuscripts; P66 (c. 200) supports the fuller Byzantine readings at John 10:19 and 10:31.

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[20] Arthur Fenton Hort, *Life and Letters of Fenton John Anthony Hort*, 2 vols. (London: Macmillan, 1896), 1:211; quoted in Jack Moorman, *Forever Settled: A Survey of the Documents and History of the Bible* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 1985), 197.

[21] Hort to Westcott, October 17, 1865, and Westcott to Hort, November 17, 1865, quoted in Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 129.

[22] Arthur Westcott, *Life and Letters of Brooke Foss Westcott*, 2 vols. (London: Macmillan, 1903), 1:117–19.

[23] Kurt Aland and Barbara Aland, *The Text of the New Testament: An Introduction to the Critical Editions and to the Theory and Practice of Modern Textual Criticism*, 2nd ed., trans. Erroll F. Rhodes (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans; Leiden: Brill, 1989), 106–9, 159–60.

[24] Gregory R. Lanier, "The Critical Editions of the Greek NT and OT: Stability, Change, and Implications," *Tyndale Bulletin* 71, no. 1 (2020): 43–63, esp. 49–54, https://doi.org/10.53751/001c.27734.

[25] James R. Royse, *Scribal Habits in Early Greek New Testament Papyri*, New Testament Tools, Studies and Documents 36 (Leiden: Brill, 2008), 705–36, especially 734.

c. *The Lucian recension.* No historical source describes Lucian of Antioch revising the Greek New Testament. Sturz catalogued about 150 distinctively Byzantine readings in early papyri, older than the supposed __recension__.[26]

REVIEW

Compare the naturalistic and faith-based methods. How does each account for the large number of Byzantine manuscripts?

[26] Harry A. Sturz, *The Byzantine Text-Type and New Testament Textual Criticism* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1984), 55–69, 79–96, 122–30, 145–59.

Part II: The Old Testament

To the Jew Were Committed the Oracles

LESSON 10 Israel's Custody of the Old Testament

Key texts: Rom. 3:1–2; 9:4; Deut. 31:24–26; 17:18; Mal. 2:7; Neh. 8:8; Ps. 147:19–20

Objectives: *(1) Explain from Scripture the Jewish custody of the Old Testament. (2) Describe the work of the scribes, Masoretes, and later punctuators.*

> **Romans 3:1–2**
> 1 *What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision?* 2 *Much every way: chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God.*

Paul names Israel's chief advantage: to them were committed the ___oracles___ of God. *Committed* denotes a trust placed in ___custody___. God gave the Old Testament through Jewish prophets and charged the Jewish people with its keeping (Rom. 9:4).

1. Custody Given by God Himself

a. When Moses finished writing the law, he gave it to the ___Levites___ to keep beside the ark of the covenant.

> **Deuteronomy 31:26**
> *Take this book of the law, and put it in the side of the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, that it may be there for a witness against thee.*

b. The priest's lips were to *keep knowledge* (Mal. 2:7), and even the king copied the law from the text kept *before the priests the Levites* (Deut. 17:18).

2. The Keepers of the Hebrew Text

Group	Period	Work
Levitical priests	From Moses	Kept the book of the law beside the ark and taught it (Deut. 31:26; Neh. 8:8)
Soferim (scribes)	From Ezra onward	Copied the consonantal text and expounded it; counted its letters
Masoretes	c. A.D. 500–1000	Added vowel points, accents, and marginal notes (the Masorah) to protect the reading
Nakdanim (punctuators)	c. 1100–1500	Supplied and corrected vowel and accent signs in later manuscripts until the printing era

a. The Talmud explains that the early scribes were called *soferim* ("counters") because they ___counted___ all the letters of the Torah.[27] The rules for preparing sacred scrolls are recorded in the tractate *Soferim*.[28]

> **NEHEMIAH 8:8**
> *So they read in the book in the law of God distinctly, and gave the sense, and caused them to understand the reading.*

3. The Rules of the Scribes

a. Traditional rules for a synagogue roll show the ___care___ with which the text was guarded:[29]

b. The roll was written on the skins of clean animals, prepared by a Jew, and fastened with strings from clean animals.

c. Columns were of fixed length; the whole was ruled; the ink was black, prepared by a set recipe.

d. The copy was made from an authentic exemplar; no word or letter might be written from ___memory___, and each word was pronounced aloud before it was written.

e. Set spaces separated letters, sections, and books. The name of God was written with a pen freshly dipped, and a copy containing a single error was withdrawn from use.

f. Josephus (c. A.D. 95) wrote that through long ages no one had dared to add to the Jewish Scriptures, to take from them, or to alter them (*Against Apion* 1.42).

4. The Contrast with Greek Handling of the Text

a. Scripture never says that the Old Testament was entrusted to a Gentile king or to Alexandrian scholars. The question of Old Testament authority begins with Romans 3:2, not with the Letter of Aristeas or with fourth-century Greek ___codices___.

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[27] Babylonian Talmud, Kiddushin 30a, in *The Talmud of Babylonia: A Translation and Commentary*, ed. Jacob Neusner (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 2011).

[28] Emanuel Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible*, 3rd ed., rev. and exp. (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 2012), 29–39, 107–10.

[29] Samuel Davidson, *The Hebrew Text of the Old Testament*, 2nd ed. (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1859), 89.

5. A Faith-Based Conclusion

a. The line of custody can be traced. God committed the Hebrew Scriptures to the Jews; their scribes copied and guarded them; the Masoretes continued that work; printed Hebrew Bibles, including the Second Rabbinic Bible of Jacob ben Chayyim (1524–25), carried the text into the Reformation; and the King James translators used that __Masoretic__ text.

> **Psalm 147:19–20**
> 19 *He sheweth his word unto Jacob, his statutes and his judgments unto Israel.* 20 *He hath not dealt so with any nation: and as for his judgments, they have not known them. Praise ye the LORD.*

REVIEW

What does Romans 3:1–2 imply about where the student of the Old Testament should look for its text?

Masoretic Text and the Dead Sea Scrolls

LESSON 11 The Hebrew Text before and after Christ

KEY TEXTS: Isa. 40:8; Matt. 5:18; Luke 24:44

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Summarize the evidence of the Dead Sea Scrolls for the Masoretic Text. (2) Explain why a later copy can preserve an older reading.*

The Masoretic Text (MT) is the traditional Hebrew text copied by Jewish scribes and furnished with vowels, accents, and marginal notes. Its great complete codices, such as the Aleppo Codex (c. 930) and the Leningrad Codex (1008), are medieval.

1. The Dead Sea Scrolls Confirm the Masoretic Text

a. The scrolls found near ____Qumran____ between 1947 and 1956 supplied Hebrew biblical manuscripts about a ___thousand___ years older than those codices. Rather than overturning the MT, they showed how carefully the Hebrew Bible had been transmitted.[30]



Figure 4. The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[a]), Israel Museum, Jerusalem: all fifty-four columns of the scroll, shown in three rows.

b. The Great ____Isaiah____ Scroll (1QIsa[a]), dated about 125 B.C., contains all sixty-six chapters of Isaiah. Millar Burrows wrote in 1948 that "the whole book is here, and it is substantially the book preserved in the Masoretic text."[31]

c. Gleason Archer estimated that the Qumran Isaiah scrolls agree word for word with the standard Hebrew text in more than _____95_____ percent of their text; most of the remainder consists of spelling variations and obvious slips of the pen.[32]

d. The second Isaiah scroll (1QIsa[b]) agrees still more closely. Jarod Jacobs counted 157

[30] Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible*, 29–39.

[31] Millar Burrows, "Variant Readings in the Isaiah Manuscript," *Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research*, no. 111 (October 1948): 16.

[32] Gleason L. Archer Jr., *A Survey of Old Testament Introduction*, updated and rev. ed. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1994), 29.

variants among 4,627 preserved words, about 3.4 percent, and Peter Flint and Eugene Ulrich classify the scroll as __proto-Masoretic__.[33]

e. Surveys of the biblical scrolls commonly classify about 60 percent as proto-Masoretic and about 5 percent as aligned with distinctive __Septuagint__ readings.[34] The Masoretic line was already established in Jewish use more than a century before Christ.

> **ISAIAH 40:8**
> *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.*

2. Archaeological Support

a. The Tel Dan Stele (ninth century B.C.) spells David's name DWD (דוד). The Great Isaiah Scroll sometimes uses the fuller DWYD (דויד), while the MT keeps the older _____DWD_____. A later copy can preserve an older form; the date of a manuscript does not fix the age of its text.

b. The Masoretes marked some words with a *qere* ("what is read") in the margin while leaving the written *ketiv* ("what is written") untouched. They would not alter the consonants they had received.

3. Jesus and the Hebrew Text Preserved by the Jews

a. Christ's *jot* and *tittle* (Matt. 5:18) are features of Hebrew script. His threefold description of the Scriptures follows the Hebrew ____canon_____, which did not include the Apocrypha.

> **LUKE 24:44**
> *And he said unto them, These are the words which I spake unto you, while I was yet with you, that all things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me.*

[33] Jarod T. Jacobs, "The Balance of Probability: A Statistically Based Analysis of the Linguistic Character of the 'Biblical' Dead Sea Scrolls" (PhD diss., University of Manchester, 2015), 91–96; Peter W. Flint and Eugene Ulrich, "The Variant Textual Readings in the Hebrew University Isaiah Scroll (1QIsab)," *Journal of Jewish Studies* 60, no. 1 (2009): 60.

[34] Lawrence H. Schiffman, *Reclaiming the Dead Sea Scrolls* (Philadelphia: Jewish Publication Society, 1994), 138.

REVIEW

Why can a later copy preserve an older reading? Use the spelling of David's name as an example.

What the Septuagint Is (and Isn't)

LESSON 12 Greek Witnesses and the Hebrew Standard

KEY TEXTS: Rom. 3:2; Luke 4:16–21; Matt. 5:18; Luke 24:44

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Distinguish the three things commonly called "the Septuagint." (2) Explain why the Hebrew text remains the standard for the Old Testament.*

The Septuagint (LXX, the Roman numeral seventy) is often described as one complete Greek Old Testament made in Alexandria about 250 B.C. and used by Jesus and the apostles. Greek translations of parts of the Old Testament existed before Christ, but the surviving evidence does not show one complete and ____fixed____ Greek Bible at that date.

1. The Modern Claim

a. Common statements combine three different things: an early Greek translation of the Law, later translations of other books, and the fourth- and fifth-century ___codices___ from which the Septuagint is reconstructed today. Evidence for one is not evidence for all three.

2. The Letter of Aristeas

a. The Letter claims that Ptolemy II Philadelphus brought seventy-two elders to Alexandria to translate the Law for his library. Even on its own terms it concerns only the __Pentateuch__, and scholars widely regard it as pseudepigraphical, probably written in the second century B.C.[35]

3. Later Accounts and the Earliest Fragments

a. Philo and Josephus repeat the story. Josephus himself says that the king received "only the books of the law" (*Antiquities* 1.12). Paul ____Kahle____ argued against the idea of one original, complete Septuagint in Jesus' day.[36]

b. The earliest Greek Old Testament manuscript, Rylands Papyrus 458 (second century B.C.), preserves only fragments of __Deuteronomy__.[37] No complete Greek Old Testament survives from before the Christian era.

[35] Karen H. Jobes and Moisés Silva, *Invitation to the Septuagint*, 2nd ed. (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2015), 37–41.

[36] Paul E. Kahle, *The Cairo Geniza*, 2nd ed. (Oxford: Basil Blackwell, 1959), 223–26.

[37] C. H. Roberts, ed., *Two Biblical Papyri in the John Rylands Library, Manchester* (Manchester: Manchester University Press, 1936).

4. Origen's Hexapla

a. Origen's Hexapla (third century) set the Hebrew text, a Greek transliteration, and the Greek versions of Aquila, Symmachus, the Septuagint, and Theodotion in six parallel ___columns___.[38] He marked his changes to the Septuagint column with critical signs; later copyists often dropped the signs, so his revisions entered the Greek text itself.[39]

5. Why the Hebrew Text Remains the Standard

a. *Custody.* God committed His oracles to the Jews (Rom. 3:2), not to a pagan king or an Alexandrian library.

b. *Canon.* The Greek codices place apocryphal books among the canonical books.

c. *Unity.* Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus differ from one another in wording, order, and contents.

d. *Method.* It is ___circular___ to correct the Hebrew by a later Greek codex and then cite the corrected reading as proof that the Hebrew is wrong.

6. Did Jesus and the Apostles Use Greek Translations?

a. New Testament quotations sometimes follow the Hebrew wording, sometimes known Greek forms, and sometimes neither, because the inspired writers translate, condense, or apply the passage. At Nazareth Christ read from a ____scroll____ of Isaiah (Luke 4:17), not from a fourth-century codex.

[38] Frederick Field, *Origenis Hexaplorum quae supersunt*, 2 vols. (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1875).

[39] Henry Barclay Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 69–72.

REVIEW

What three things does the word "Septuagint" commonly describe, and why does the distinction matter?

Part III: The New Testament

The Text the Church Actually Used

LESSON 13 The Word Received, Read, and Kept

Key texts: 1 Thess. 2:13; 5:27; Col. 4:16; Rom. 16:22; 2 Tim. 2:2; 1 Pet. 2:5, 9; 1 Tim. 3:15

Objectives: *(1) Describe how the New Testament was written, circulated, copied, and received. (2) Explain the priesthood of believers as the means of New Testament preservation.*

The decisive question is not only which manuscript is oldest but which text the churches actually ___received___, read, preached, and copied.

> **1 Thessalonians 2:13**
> *For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because, when ye received the word of God which ye heard of us, ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God, which effectually worketh also in you that believe.*

The traditional text is not always represented by the oldest surviving copies, because heavily used copies were read, recopied, and ___worn out___. The name *Textus Receptus* reflects that history of use.

1. The Process of New Testament Preservation

Stage	Scripture
1. The Holy Spirit revealed truth to the apostles	John 16:13
2. The apostles and their scribes wrote it down	1 Cor. 5:9; Eph. 3:3; Rom. 16:22
3. The letters were delivered to churches and individuals	Col. 4:16; 3 John 9
4. The recipients read them aloud, copied, and exchanged them	Col. 4:16; 1 Thess. 5:27
5. Faithful men received and passed them to others	2 Tim. 2:2; 1 Tim. 6:20

a. Because the New Testament passed through many scattered Gentile churches rather than one central priesthood, its transmission was more laborious than that of the Old Testament. It was preserved by the __priesthood__ of believers functioning in local churches (1 Pet. 2:5).

> **Colossians 4:16**
> *And when this epistle is read among you, cause that it be read also in the church of the Laodiceans; and that ye likewise read the epistle from Laodicea.*

b. John Burgon observed that lectionaries "establish the Text which has been publicly

read in the churches of the East, from at least A.D. 400 until the time of the invention of printing."[40]

c. The church did not make Scripture inspired by receiving it, but its reception is historical ___evidence___ of preservation. A text read in worship, translated for missions, and copied for generations has a different history from a manuscript that fell out of use.

2. Edward Hills on Naturalism and Faith

a. Hills, trained at Yale, Westminster, and Harvard, argued that naturalistic criticism studies the New Testament "in the same way in which we study the texts of secular books which have not been preserved by God's special providence."[41] Westcott and Hort had declared that they dared not introduce considerations that could not reasonably be applied to other ___ancient___ texts.[42]

b. Daniel Wallace states the principle directly: "A theological a priori has no place in textual criticism."[43]

c. Hills did not reject scholarship. He insisted that it remain under the authority of Scripture and the faith of God's people.

> **PSALM 119:99**
> *I have more understanding than all my teachers: for thy testimonies are my meditation.*

3. The Priesthood of Believers and the Preservation of Scripture

a. Hills wrote that "the New Testament text has been preserved by the universal priesthood of believers, by faithful Christians in every walk of life."[44]

> **1 PETER 2:9**
> *But ye are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light:*

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[40] John William Burgon, *The Revision Revised* (London: John Murray, 1883), 11.

[41] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 320.

[42] Westcott and Hort, *New Testament in the Original Greek*, 2:277.

[43] Daniel B. Wallace, "Challenges in New Testament Textual Criticism for the Twenty-First Century," *Journal of the Evangelical Theological Society* 52, no. 1 (March 2009): 86.

[44] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 144.

b. As the Levites kept the Old Testament, the New Testament was entrusted to the believing ____church____, which Paul calls *the pillar and ground of the truth* (1 Tim. 3:15).

4. From the Church's Received Text to the King James Bible

a. The chain runs from apostolic circulation to early versions, lectionaries, patristic quotation, and the multiplication of Byzantine manuscripts; printing then carried that tradition into the Reformation as the Textus Receptus, which the King James Bible rendered into ___English___.

REVIEW

Why might the most-used manuscripts be less likely to survive than unused ones? What does this imply for the claim that the oldest is best?

Evidence: Manuscripts, Versions, and Fathers

LESSON 14 Three Kinds of Witnesses

KEY TEXTS: Deut. 19:15; Matt. 18:16; 2 Cor. 13:1

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Classify the witnesses to the New Testament text. (2) Summarize the evidence favoring the Received Text.*

Textual evidence comes in three kinds: Greek __manuscripts__, ancient versions (translations), and quotations in early Christian writers. The date of a witness, the date of its reading, and the kind of witness must be kept distinct.

> **DEUTERONOMY 19:15**
> *One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin, in any sin that he sinneth: at the mouth of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall the matter be established.*

1. Manuscript Evidence

a. The Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF) in Münster catalogues about __5,700__ Greek New Testament manuscripts, most of them partial, in four categories: papyri, majuscules, minuscules, and lectionaries.[45]

b. The readings of these manuscripts reflect the Byzantine text-type 80 to 95 percent of the time.[46] Fewer than fifty are consistently Alexandrian, and three of them, B, א, and A, form the __backbone__ of the critical text.

c. Zane Hodges argued that "the copies nearest the autograph will normally have the largest number of descendants."[47] Hort himself allowed "a theoretical presumption" that a majority of extant documents represents a __majority__ of ancestral documents.[48]

d. Jack Moorman observed that with some 85 percent of manuscripts belonging to the Received Text, there is in fact one textual family; the remainder is too mixed to form genuine families.[49]

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[45] Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), "The Greek Manuscripts of the New Testament," New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (NTVMR), University of Münster, accessed June 30, 2026, https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de/.

[46] Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1977), 155–56.

[47] Zane C. Hodges, "Modern Textual Criticism and the Majority Text: A Defense," *Bibliotheca Sacra* 125, no. 517 (January–March 1968): 1.

[48] Westcott and Hort, *New Testament in the Original Greek*, 2:45.

[49] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 54.

2. Early Readings

a. Byzantine readings appear early in the Syriac ___Peshitta___[50] and in the Old Latin, which most scholars place in North Africa by the late second century.[51] The Gothic version was translated by Ulfilas about A.D. 350.[52]

b. P66 (c. 200) and P45 (third century) contain readings later preserved in the Byzantine tradition, and Sturz identified about 150 distinctively Byzantine readings in early papyri.[53] Codex Alexandrinus (A) is predominantly Byzantine in the ___Gospels___.

c. Moorman compared the great uncials ℵ, A, C, D(05), and D(06) with the Textus Receptus and Vaticanus where those two differ: the uncials side with the TR 7,909 times and with Vaticanus 5,924 times.[54]

3. Patristic Quotations

a. From Polycarp to A.D. 400, more than 2,630 patristic quotations reflect the Received Text.[55] ___Irenaeus___ (c. 180) quotes Mark 16:19 as the conclusion of Mark's Gospel,[56] and Cyprian (c. 250) cites *and these three are one* from 1 John 5:7.

b. Patristic evidence is weighed with care, since a writer may quote loosely and his works were copied by hand. A clear citation nevertheless fixes a reading at a known date and place, and these witnesses show disputed Received Text readings in the second and third __centuries__.

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[50] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 227.

[51] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 50.

[52] Kenyon, *Handbook*, 240.

[53] Sturz, *Byzantine Text-Type*, 145–59.

[54] Jack A. Moorman, *Early Manuscripts, Church Fathers, and the Authorized Version: With Manuscript Digests and Summaries* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2005), 45–51.

[55] Frederic G. Kenyon, *Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament* (London: Macmillan, 1901), 375–76.

[56] Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* 3.10.5, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 1, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1994), 426.

4. Factors Favoring the Received Text

Factor	Evidence
1. Number	The large majority of Greek manuscripts
2. Antiquity of use	Readings attested in the second-century versions and fathers
3. Breadth	Used and translated in Asia, Africa, and Europe; read in the lectionaries
4. Reception	Received and believed by the churches for well over a thousand years
5. Character of its rivals	The Alexandrian witnesses disagree with one another (Lesson 15)

a. The traditional text was defended in the nineteenth century by John William Burgon, Edward Miller, and Herman Hoskier, whose arguments, the course notes observe, were more often set aside than ___answered___.

REVIEW

Which kind of witness provides the earliest evidence for Mark 16:9–20? Why is that significant?

The Alexandrian Cluster (B, א, A) in Context

LESSON 15 The Great Codices Examined

KEY TEXTS: Matt. 7:16–20; Matt. 24:35

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Describe the history and contents of Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus. (2) Evaluate the claim that these codices are the "oldest and best."*

Modern critical editions give the greatest weight to three codices: Vaticanus (B, c. 325–350), Sinaiticus (א, c. 330–360), and Alexandrinus (A, c. 400–450). Each is connected with Egypt and the Alexandrian text.

1. Vaticanus (B)

a. Some scholars identify B and א with the ____fifty____ Bibles Constantine ordered from Eusebius of Caesarea for the churches of Constantinople.[57] A. T. Robertson judged it "quite possible that א and B are two of these fifty, though the actual copying was probably done in Egypt or by Egyptian scribes."[58]

b. Through physical loss, B's New Testament breaks off at ___Hebrews___ 9:14; it lacks the Pastoral Epistles, Philemon, and Revelation. Its Old Testament includes the Apocrypha. It appears in a Vatican Library catalogue of 1475.[59] Tischendorf was permitted to study it for about forty-two hours before publishing his edition of 1867.[60]

c. B ends Mark at 16:8 but leaves the following column blank, the only such blank column in its New Testament.

[57] Eusebius of Caesarea, *Life of Constantine*, trans. Averil Cameron and Stuart G. Hall (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1999), 166–69 (IV.36–37); T. C. Skeat, "The Codex Sinaiticus, the Codex Vaticanus and Constantine," *Journal of Theological Studies*, n.s., 50, no. 2 (1999): 583–625.

[58] A. T. Robertson, *An Introduction to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament* (Nashville: Sunday School Board of the Southern Baptist Convention, 1925), 80.

[59] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 48.

[60] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 129.

2. Sinaiticus (א)

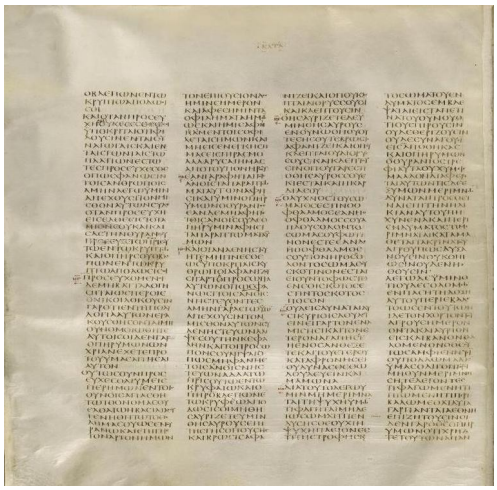


Figure 5. Codex Sinaiticus (א), British Library, Matthew 6:4–32. Four columns of majuscule script per page; later correctors' marks appear between the lines and in the margins.

a. Constantin von Tischendorf obtained leaves of א at St. Catherine's Monastery, Mount Sinai, in 1844; by his own account some lay in a ____basket____ of material to be burned. The bulk followed in 1859, and the British Museum bought the codex from the Soviet government in 1933.[61]

b. The codex has four columns of forty-eight lines per page.[62] It bears thousands of corrections by later hands; a note at the end of Esdras states that its exemplar was corrected against the Hexapla of ____Origen____.[63]

3. The Testimony of the Collations

a. Using the Received Text as a standard, Burgon tabulated the departures of B and א in the four Gospels:[64]

Codex	Omits	Adds	Substitutes	Transposes	Modifies	Total
B	2,877	536	935	2,098	1,132	7,578
א	3,455	839	1,114	2,299	1,265	8,972

b. Herman Hoskier counted 3,036 differences between B and א in the Gospels alone.[65]

[61] Codex Sinaiticus Project, "History of Codex Sinaiticus," accessed September 22, 2026, https://www.codexsinaiticus.org/en/codex/history.aspx.

[62] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 83.

[63] J. F. Fenlon, "Codex Sinaiticus," *The Catholic Encyclopedia* 4 (New York: Robert Appleton, 1908), 85–86.

[64] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 84–85.

[65] H. C. Hoskier, *Codex B and Its Allies: A Study and an Indictment*, 2 vols. (London: Bernard Quaritch, 1914), 2:1.

Burgon remarked, "It is in fact easier to find two consecutive verses in which B and א differ, than two consecutive verses in which they ___agree___."[66]

4. Alexandrinus (A)

a. Codex A was presented to __Charles I___ of England in 1627. Its text is mixed: Byzantine in the Gospels, Alexandrian in Acts and the Epistles, and distinctive in Revelation.

5. Two Streams in Summary

	Majority (Byzantine) line	**Minority (Alexandrian) line**
Origin	Antioch and the Greek-speaking churches	Alexandria, Egypt
Principal witnesses	Most Greek manuscripts; lectionaries	B, א, and a small group of allies
Support	Early versions and fathers	Some papyri; Origen's tradition
Printed form	The Textus Receptus	Westcott–Hort (1881); NA/UBS
English Bible	The King James Bible	RV (1881) and modern versions
History	Read and copied by the churches	Preserved chiefly in __libraries

> **MATTHEW 7:16**
> *Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles?*

REVIEW

"Age without use is no virtue." Evaluate this statement in light of the history of B and א.

[66] Burgon, *Revision Revised*, 12.

FROM THE RECEIVED TEXT TO THE KING JAMES BIBLE

LESSON 16 The Preparation and Completion of the English Bible

KEY TEXTS: Ps. 12:6–7; Prov. 11:14; Eccl. 8:4; Acts 15:6, 22

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Trace the English Bible from Wycliffe to 1611. (2) Describe the rules, companies, and review process of the King James translators.*

1. The English Bible Prepared the Way

a. John Wycliffe, called "the morning star of the Reformation," appealed to Scripture as the supreme authority.[67] The Wycliffite Bible of the 1380s, the first complete Bible in English, was translated from Latin and copied by hand; about 250 manuscripts survive.[68]

b. William ___Tyndale___ vowed that a boy that driveth the plough should know more of the Scripture than a learned opponent.[69] He printed the first English New Testament translated from Greek (1526) and the Pentateuch from Hebrew (1530). Nielson and Skousen estimate that about 84 percent of the words of the KJV New Testament are Tyndale's.[70]

c. Tyndale was strangled and burned at Vilvorde in 1536, praying, "Lord, open the King of England's eyes." Within three years the Great Bible stood in England's ___churches___.

2. Printing, Erasmus, and the Reformation Bibles

a. Johannes Gutenberg's press, using movable type, produced its first great book, the Latin Bible, about 1455.[71] Printing multiplied identical copies and carried the Scriptures further than any means before it.

b. Desiderius ___Erasmus___ (c. 1466–1536), the leading scholar of his age, printed the first Greek New Testament in 1516. In its preface he wished the Scriptures translated into all languages, that the farmer might sing them at the plow and the weaver at his loom.[72]

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[67] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 139.

[68] Anne Hudson, "The First Complete English Bible," *Tyndale Society Journal*, no. 2; Mary Dove, *The First English Bible: The Text and Context of the Wycliffite Versions* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2007), 281–306.

[69] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 160.

[70] Jon Nielson and Royal Skousen, "How Much of the King James Bible Is William Tyndale's? An Estimation Based on Sampling," *Reformation* 3, no. 1 (1998): 49–74, https://doi.org/10.1179/ref_1998_3_1_004.

[71] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 112–13.

[72] Desiderius Erasmus, *Paraclesis*, preface to *Novum Instrumentum omne* (Basel: Johann Froben, 1516).

Reformation Bible	Date
Luther's German New Testament; complete Bible	1522; 1534
Olivetan's French Bible	1535
Swedish (Uppsala) Bible	1541
Danish (Christian III) Bible	1550
Spanish Bible of Casiodoro de Reina	1569
Czech (Kralice) Bible	1579–93
Diodati's Italian Bible	1607

c. Coverdale (1535) produced the first complete printed English Bible; Matthew's Bible (1537) joined Tyndale and Coverdale; the Great Bible (1539) was appointed for the parish churches.[73] The Geneva Bible (1560) was the first complete English Bible with numbered ____verses____.[74]

3. The Hampton Court Conference

a. On his way south in 1603, James VI of Scotland, now James I of England, received the Millenary Petition, said to bear the names of a thousand Puritan ministers. He answered it with a conference at __Hampton Court__ in January 1604.[75]

b. There John Rainolds (Reynolds), president of Corpus Christi College, Oxford, asked that "the Bible be new translated, such as are extant not answering the original."[76] The king ordered a translation "as consonant as can be to the original Hebrew and Greek," to be printed without marginal notes and read in all the churches.

c. No existing Bible could unite the nation: the Great Bible was cumbersome, the king objected to the Geneva notes, and the Bishops' Bible had not won the people. The Bishops' Bible of 1602 became the translators' ___starting___ text.[77]

> **ECCLESIASTES 8:4**
> *Where the word of a king is, there is power: and who may say unto him, What doest thou?*

[73] J. F. Mozley, *Coverdale and His Bibles* (London: Lutterworth Press, 1953), 221.

[74] Kent P. Jackson, Frank F. Judd Jr., and David R. Seely, "Chapters, Verses, Punctuation, Spelling, and Italics," in *The King James Bible and the Restoration*, ed. Kent P. Jackson (Provo, UT: Religious Studies Center, Brigham Young University, 2011), 95–117; Bruce M. Metzger, "The Geneva Bible of 1560," *Theology Today* 17, no. 3 (October 1960): 339–52.

[75] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 186–87.

[76] William Barlow, *The Summe and Substance of the Conference … at Hampton Court* (London: Mathew Law, 1604), 45–46.

[77] "The Rules to Be Observed in the Translation of the Bible," in Alfred W. Pollard, ed., *Records of the English Bible* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1911), 53–55; David Norton, *A Textual History of the King James Bible* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2005), 8, 23–24.

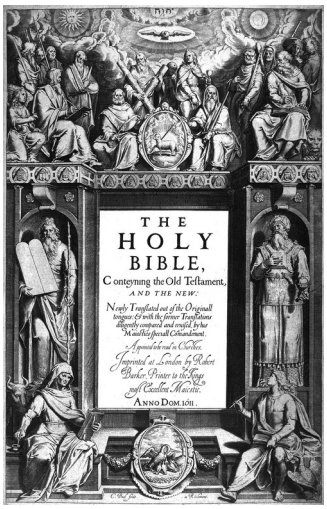


Figure 6. Title page of the 1611 King James Bible: "Newly Translated out of the Originall tongues: & with the former Translations diligently compared and reuised."

4. How the King James Translators Worked

a. Fifty-four men were appointed; the names of forty-seven survive. They worked in ____six____ companies, two each at Westminster, Oxford, and Cambridge (see Appendix B).[78]

b. Fifteen ___rules___ governed the work (Appendix C). Rule 1 made the Bishops' Bible the base, "as little altered as the Truth of the original will permit"; Rule 14 required comparison with Tyndale, Matthew, Coverdale, Whitchurch (the Great Bible), and Geneva "when they agree better with the Text."

c. Each translator worked the passage alone; his company compared and agreed on a text; finished books went to the other companies; differences went to a general __meeting__ (Rules 8–10).

d. A final committee of twelve, two from each company, reviewed the whole for about nine months at Stationers' Hall in London.[79] Miles Smith and Thomas Bilson saw it through the press, and Robert Barker, the King's Printer, issued it in 1611 with 8,422 marginal notes.[80]

[78] David Norton, *The King James Bible: A Short History from Tyndale to Today* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2011), 54–55.

[79] Ward Allen, *Translating for King James: Notes Made by a Translator of King James's Bible* (Nashville: Vanderbilt University Press, 1969), 28–35.

[80] F. H. A. Scrivener, *The Authorized Edition of the English Bible (1611): Its Subsequent Reprints and Modern Representatives* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1884), 56, 69–71.

5. The Historical Setting

a. The work was carried through in a dangerous season: the Spanish Armada was defeated in 1588, the Gunpowder Plot against King James and Parliament failed in November 1605, and the Roman Catholic Douay–Rheims Bible was completed in 1609–10.

6. Why the Process Ends with the King James Bible

a. Six marks converge: the Masoretic Hebrew text, the Received Greek Text, a ___formal___ (word-for-word) method, the strength of earlier English Bibles, layered review, and centuries of reception by English-speaking churches.

> **Proverbs 11:14**
> *Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.*

REVIEW

Why would repeated independent and group review strengthen a translation? Compare Proverbs 11:14 and Acts 15:6, 22.

Part IV: Other Issues

Translation Practices: Dynamic vs. Formal Equivalence: Why Translation Philosophy Matters

LESSON 17 Translating the Words God Gave

Key texts: Deut. 4:2; Prov. 30:5–6; Matt. 4:4; Jer. 23:36

Objectives: *(1) Define translation, version, paraphrase, and transliteration. (2) Distinguish formal from dynamic equivalence and evaluate their consequences.*

English Bibles differ for two reasons: they translate different Hebrew or Greek readings, or they translate the same reading by different ___methods___. In the worst cases both causes combine.

1. Four Terms

Term	Definition	Example
Translation	Rendering a work from one language into another	The Geneva Bible
Version	A particular translation of Scripture	The King James Version
Paraphrase	Restating the sense in the translator's own words	The Living Bible (1971)
Transliteration	Carrying a word over by its sound	*Amen, hallelujah, baptize*

2. Formal and Dynamic Equivalence

a. ___Formal___ (verbal) equivalence renders the words and structures of the original as closely as the receiving language allows. The King James Bible follows this method, consistent with Scripture's claim to the inspiration of words (Matt. 4:4; Prov. 30:5).

b. ___Dynamic___ (functional) equivalence, formulated by Eugene Nida in the mid-twentieth century, seeks to reproduce the thought or effect the translator believes the text conveys, restructuring sentences for the modern reader.[81] Its measure is the reader's response rather than fidelity to the words. Nida's method shaped the Good News Bible (1976) and the New Living Translation (1996).

> **Deuteronomy 4:2**
> *Ye shall not add unto the word which I command you, neither shall ye diminish ought from it, that ye may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you.*

[81] Eugene A. Nida, *Toward a Science of Translating* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1964), 159, 166–68.

3. The Translator's Responsibility

a. Formal equivalence lets the reader see what the text says and interpret it himself. Dynamic equivalence places the translator's __interpretation__ into the text itself, where the reader cannot separate it from the original.

b. D. A. Waite warned that for a work presented as a translation of God's words to add words of its own "is adding to the Words of God."[82] He likened the serpent's handling of God's command in Genesis 3 to a loose __paraphrase__.[83]

c. The King James translators marked ___supplied___ words, those required by English but not represented by a separate Hebrew or Greek word. The 1611 printing set them in roman type within its blackletter; later editions use italics.[84]

> **PROVERBS 30:6**
> *Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.*

4. The Aim of the 1611 Translators

a. The translators described their purpose: "to make a good one better, or out of many good ones, one principal good one, not justly to be excepted against."[85] They set out to perfect a received English tradition, not to replace it.

5. Conclusion: The Dangers of Dynamic Equivalence

a. Even a sound underlying text can be corrupted by a thought-for-thought method, because the translator is free to restate God's words in his own. The issue is both which manuscripts are used and _____how_____ they are translated.

b. At root the difference concerns what the Bible is: the very words of God, or a vehicle for religious ____ideas____.

> **JEREMIAH 23:36**
> *And the burden of the LORD shall ye mention no more: for every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.*

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[82] D. A. Waite, *Defending the King James Bible: A Fourfold Superiority—Texts, Translators, Technique, Theology*, 3rd ed. (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2006), 151.

[83] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, 119.

[84] Jackson, Judd, and Seely, "Chapters, Verses," 101–2.

[85] "Translators to the Reader," 296–97.

REVIEW

Choose a verse and compare a formal rendering with a dynamic one. What is gained, and what is lost?

Doctrinal Issues (Why the "small" changes aren't small)

LESSON 18 The Person of Christ and the Gospel

KEY TEXTS: 1 Tim. 3:16; Phil. 2:6; John 1:18; 1 John 5:7; Luke 2:33; Dan. 3:25; Col. 1:14; Acts 8:37

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Explain why textual and translational differences bear on doctrine. (2) Evaluate readings concerning the deity of Christ and the gospel.*

It is often said that the differences between versions affect no doctrine. A doctrine may survive elsewhere while a particular verse's testimony to it is weakened or removed. God promised to preserve every word (Matt. 4:4), not merely enough ____verses____ for each doctrine.

1 Timothy 3:16

KJV *God was manifest in the flesh*

ESV "He was manifested in the flesh"[86]

The Received Text reads θεός (God); the critical text reads ὅς (who). The KJV states that ____God____ Himself was manifest in the flesh; *He* leaves the subject indefinite.[87]

Philippians 2:6

KJV *Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God*

ESV "who, though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped"

The KJV states that equality with God was Christ's by right; the modern rendering can be read as though it were something He did not possess.

John 1:18

KJV *the only begotten Son, which is in the bosom of the Father*

ESV "the only God, who is at the Father's side"

The KJV reads μονογενὴς υἱός (only begotten Son), preserving the distinction of Father and ____Son____ within the one Godhead.

1 John 5:7

KJV *For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.*

NIV "For there are three that testify"

Modern versions omit the heavenly witnesses or relegate them to a ___footnote___, removing the most explicit statement of the ___Trinity___ in Scripture. Lesson 22 examines the verse's history.

[86] English Standard Version.

[87] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, chap. 5, sec. 3(h), discussion of 1 Timothy 3:16.

Luke 2:33

KJV *And Joseph and his mother marvelled*

ESV "And his father and his mother marveled"

The KJV names Joseph, guarding the __virgin birth__; the critical text calls him Jesus' father (ὁ πατὴρ αὐτοῦ). Luke records that Jesus was *as was supposed* the son of Joseph (Luke 3:23).

Luke 2:22

KJV *the days of her purification*

CSB "the days of their purification"

The law of Moses required the purification of the mother after childbirth (Lev. 12:2–6), not of both parents.

Daniel 3:25

KJV *the form of the fourth is like the Son of God*

NASB "the appearance of the fourth is like a son of the gods"

The KJV preserves the testimony that the fourth man in the fire bore the likeness of the Son of God.

Colossians 1:14

KJV *In whom we have redemption through his blood, even the forgiveness of sins*

NIV "in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins"

The critical text omits *through his blood*. The phrase remains in Ephesians 1:7, but Colossians loses its own statement of the ____means_____ of redemption (cf. Heb. 9:12, 22).

Acts 8:37

KJV *If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. … I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.*

CSB Verse omitted; placed in a footnote

The omission removes the testimony that faith in Christ precedes ___baptism___. Irenaeus (c. 180) already cites the eunuch's confession.[88]

[88] Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* 3.12.8.

REVIEW

Choose one of the passages above and explain what doctrine is affected by the modern reading.

Doctrinal Issues (Why the "small" changes aren't small)

LESSON 19 Prayer, Accuracy, and the Gospel

KEY TEXTS: Mark 9:29; Matt. 17:21; Luke 11:2–4; Mark 1:2; Ps. 12:7; Matt. 9:13; Rom. 8:1; Matt. 6:13; John 7:8; 3:16; Matt. 5:22

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Evaluate textual differences affecting prayer, accuracy, and the gospel. (2) Distinguish differences of text from differences of translation.*

Mark 9:29

KJV *This kind can come forth by nothing, but by prayer and fasting.*

CSB "This kind can come out by nothing but prayer."

The shorter reading removes ___fasting___ from Christ's instruction. The words *and fasting* stand in P45 (third century), the earliest manuscript of the passage, and are omitted chiefly by ℵ and B.

Matthew 17:21

KJV *Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.*

NIV Verse omitted

The parallel verse is removed entirely, so the teaching disappears from both ___Gospels___. Christ assumed His disciples would fast (Matt. 6:16–18; 9:15). When a teaching is removed in two places at once, the change is a ___pattern___.

Luke 11:2

KJV *Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth.*

NASB "Father, hallowed be Your name. Your kingdom come."

The shorter text of Luke's prayer also omits *deliver us from evil* in verse 4.

Mark 1:2

KJV *As it is written in the prophets*

ESV "As it is written in Isaiah the prophet"

Mark quotes Malachi 3:1 and then Isaiah 40:3. *In the prophets* is exact; *in Isaiah the prophet* attributes a quotation of Malachi to ___Isaiah___.

Psalm 12:7

KJV *Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

NIV "You, LORD, will keep the needy safe and will protect us forever from the wicked."

The KJV applies verse 7 to the *words* of verse 6; the NIV applies it to people, removing a principal Old Testament promise of preservation.

Matthew 9:13

KJV *I am not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.*

CSB "For I didn't come to call the righteous, but sinners."

Without *to repentance* the purpose of Christ's call is incomplete; even the critical text retains the words at Luke 5:32.

Romans 8:1

KJV *There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.*

ESV "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

The KJV retains Paul's description of those in Christ as walking after the ___Spirit___, the theme of 8:4–14.

Matthew 6:13

KJV *For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.*

ESV Omitted from the text; placed in a footnote

The closing ___doxology___ of the Lord's Prayer returns the prayer to the praise of God.

John 7:8

KJV *I go not up yet unto this feast*

ESV "I am not going up to this feast"

Christ went up to the feast a few days later (John 7:10). *Yet* preserves the truthfulness of His statement.

John 3:16

KJV *his only begotten Son*

NIV "his one and only Son"

Believers are sons of God by adoption (Gal. 4:5), but Christ alone is the only ___begotten___ Son of the Father.

1. Further Comparisons from the Class Notes

a. Some differences arise from the underlying text, others from translation. The first example below is textual; the rest are __translational__.

Passage	KJV	Modern rendering	Observation
Matt. 5:22	*angry with his brother without a cause*	"angry with his brother" (ESV)	Omits the qualifier; compare *hated me without a cause* (Ps. 69:4; John 15:25)
Gen. 37:3	*a coat of many colours*	"an ornate robe" (NIV)	The same Hebrew phrase describes Tamar's royal garment of *divers colours* (2 Sam. 13:18)
Rom. 1:25	*changed the truth of God into a lie*	"exchanged the truth about God for a lie" (ESV)	The KJV keeps the truth *of* God, which men corrupt
2 Tim. 2:15	*Study to shew thyself approved*	"Do your best to present yourself" (ESV)	The KJV joins diligence to the study of the Word
Judg. 5:14	*they that handle the pen of the writer*	"those who bear a commander's staff" (NIV)	The KJV records writing with a pen in the time of the judges
1 Cor. 11:1	*Be ye followers of me*	"Be imitators of me" (ESV)	Following is obedience; imitation can be counterfeit (2 Cor. 11:13–15)

b. In each case the reader of a formal English Bible can see the words and weigh the __difference__ for himself.

REVIEW

Why is it insufficient to say that a doctrine "is still taught somewhere else in the Bible"?

Ease of Reading

LESSON 20 Understanding and Teaching the Words

Key texts: Ps. 119:130; Prov. 2:4–5; Luke 22:31–32; Mark 12:37; Ps. 19:7

Objectives: *(1) Evaluate the claim that the KJV is too difficult to read. (2) Explain the value of the KJV's pronouns and oral cadence.*

The most frequent practical objection to the King James Bible is that it is too hard to read. The claim can be tested rather than assumed.

1. What the Numbers Actually Say

a. Readability formulas such as the Flesch–Kincaid ___Grade Level___ measure sentence length and syllables per word. Sample KJV passages score near the eighth grade: Genesis 1 at 8.1, Romans 8 at 7.7, and Romans 3:1–23 at 5.6.

b. Emilio Matricciani (2023) estimated about eight years of schooling for the KJV of Matthew, compared with more than ___thirteen___ for the NASB and about six for the NIV.[89]

c. By these measures the KJV is not the ___hardest___ English Bible. Readability formulas measure form, not depth: *In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God* (John 1:1) is written almost entirely in words of one syllable.

2. Archaic Words: A Help, Not a Hindrance

a. *Thou*, *thee*, and *thy* are ___singular___; *ye*, *you*, and *your* are plural.[90] Modern English has lost the distinction.

> **Luke 22:31–32**
> 31 *And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he*
> *may sift you as wheat:* 32 *But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and when*
> *thou art converted, strengthen thy brethren.*

b. Satan desired to have *you*, all the disciples; Christ prayed for *thee*, Peter. Versions that render both as *you* obscure the ___contrast___. The older verb forms (*thou hast, he hath*) likewise mark person and number.

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[89] Emilio Matricciani, "Readability across Time and Languages: The Case of Matthew's Gospel Translations," *AppliedMath* 3, no. 2 (2023): 497–509.

[90] *Oxford English Dictionary*, s.v. "thou, pron.," OED Online (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2023).

3. Designed for Oral Clarity

a. Gordon Campbell describes the KJV's formal idiom as rhetorical, suited to public reading;[91] Leland Ryken argues that its archaisms are few and its diction concrete.[92] It was made for the _____ear_____ as well as the eye.

4. Readability Is Not Shallowness

> **Psalm 119:130**
> *The entrance of thy words giveth light; it giveth understanding unto the simple.*

a. Understanding comes by searching *as for hid treasures* (Prov. 2:4–5). The KJV's vocabulary is largely plain Anglo-Saxon (*sin, blood, law, grace*), while its cadence invites __memorization__.

5. Historical Reality: Ordinary People Read It

a. For four centuries the KJV was the Bible of ordinary believers, as Christ's own words were heard by the common people *gladly* (Mark 12:37). David Crystal traces more than 250 of its expressions into everyday English ____idiom____.[93]

b. The difficulty of Scripture lies less in its vocabulary than in the heart: *the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God* (1 Cor. 2:14).

> **Psalm 19:7**
> *The law of the LORD is perfect, converting the soul: the testimony of the LORD is sure, making wise the simple.*

[91] Gordon Campbell, *Bible: The Story of the King James Version, 1611–2011* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), 170.

[92] Leland Ryken, "Ten Fallacies about the King James Version," *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* 15, no. 4 (2011): 11–14.

[93] David Crystal, *Begat: The King James Bible and the English Language* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010).

REVIEW

Explain the difference between *thee* and *you* in Luke 22:31–32 and why it matters for interpretation.

Major FAQs

LESSON 21 General Questions about the King James Bible

KEY TEXTS: Ps. 12:6–7; Matt. 24:35; Num. 25:9; 1 Cor. 10:8; Acts 12:1–4; 2 Cor. 2:17

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Answer the common general objections to the King James Bible. (2) Support each answer from Scripture and history.*

Q1. How can the King James Bible be the standard when it is one translation among many?

a. Every generation must have a standard. God promised to preserve His words (Ps. 12:6–7; Matt. 24:35), so they must exist in a form His people can use. For nearly three centuries the KJV was the ___standard___ by which English-speaking believers measured other translations.

Q2. Did the translators admit their work was imperfect?

a. The preface grants that even the "meanest" translation is still the Word of God, but that humility does not limit God's use of the work. The translators "trusted in him that hath the key of David" and ____prayed____ that they might not be deceived in the Scriptures nor deceive by them.[94]

Q3. Is the language too archaic for modern readers?

a. See Lesson 20. Edward Hills argued that the language of the Bible "should be venerable as well as intelligible," and that the KJV fulfills both requirements better than any other English Bible.[95]

Q4. Does the KJV contain errors or contradictions?

a. Alleged discrepancies have reasonable explanations. Numbers 25:9 records 24,000 deaths and 1 Corinthians 10:8 records 23,000 *in one day*. Differing ages of kings often reflect __co-regency__ with a father.

Q5. Did the 1611 edition include the Apocrypha?

a. Yes, but set apart between the Testaments, not mingled with Scripture as in Vaticanus

[94] "Translators to the Reader," 296–97.

[95] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 170.

and Sinaiticus. The confessions of the period declare that these books, "not being of divine inspiration, are no part of the ____canon_____ of the Scripture."[96]

Q6. Which revision of the KJV is the perfect one?

a. The question confuses revisions with ___editions___. Later printings standardized spelling and type and corrected printers' errors; the standard text today derives from Benjamin Blayney's Oxford edition of 1769. Waite counts only 421 changes of sound between the 1611 text and the present one.[97]

Q7. Is it divisive to insist on the KJV?

a. Unity must rest on truth. Paul warned of *many, which corrupt the word of God* (2 Cor. 2:17), and the question of which Bible concerns the source of all doctrine. The conviction is held *in meekness* (2 Tim. 2:25).

Q8. Did God preserve His Word only in English?

a. God's preserved words stand in the Masoretic Hebrew and the Received Greek, purified in English in the KJV. Faithful translations from those texts into other languages are *perfect* in the biblical sense of complete, lacking nothing ____needed____.

Q9. Are modern scholars better equipped than those of 1611?

a. The translators included the leading Hebraists and Grecians of their day. Lancelot Andrewes was master of some fifteen languages, and John Bois had read the Bible in Hebrew by the age of five.[98] Modern databases increase access to data but do not decide which text God has preserved.

Q10. If the KJV is perfect, why not call it inspired?

a. Inspiration is the initial giving; preservation is the keeping; purification is the providential refining. The KJV is not newly inspired but ___purified___ (Lesson 6).

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[96] Westminster Assembly, *The Westminster Confession of Faith* (1647), 1.3.

[97] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, introduction, sec. D.

[98] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, chap. 3, secs. D–E.

Q11. Is "Easter" in Acts 12:4 a mistake?

a. The Greek πάσχα can denote the Passover or the wider festival season. Verse 3 places Peter's arrest during *the days of unleavened bread*, after the Passover itself, and Herod planned to act after the season. Tyndale had used *ester* for πάσχα, and the KJV retains the ___English___ name of the season here.

Q12. Why does the KJV use italicized words?

a. Italics mark ___supplied___ words required by English grammar but not represented by a separate word in the original. They show the translators' candor; most modern versions supply words without marking them.

REVIEW

Choose one question above and write a two-sentence answer you could give to a fellow believer.

Major FAQs

LESSON 22 Technical Questions and Concluding Confidence

Key texts: 1 John 5:7; Mark 16:9–20; Acts 8:37; Rev. 22:19; Prov. 22:20–21; Isa. 40:8

Objectives: *(1) Summarize the evidence for three disputed passages. (2) State the argument of the course from inspiration to the King James Bible.*

Q13. Did Erasmus add the Johannine Comma (1 John 5:7)?

a. The Greek manuscript support is late: GA 629 (1362–63), GA 61 (c. 1520), and GA 918 (sixteenth century) contain it. The reading is much older in Latin: Cyprian (c. 250) cites *these three are one*, Priscillian (c. 380) gives the full heavenly-witness form, and the African bishops at Carthage cited it in _____484_____.[99]

b. The Complutensian Polyglot printed the verse in 1514; Erasmus included it in his third edition of 1522. Henk Jan de Jonge showed there is no evidence that Erasmus ___promised___ to include it if shown a Greek manuscript.[100]

Q14. Is Mark 16:9–20 a later addition?

a. About 1,653 Greek manuscripts and more than 1,000 lectionaries contain the passage; the principal Greek manuscripts ending at 16:8 are א, B, and minuscule 304. Codices A, C, D, and W contain it, and it was known to Tatian's Diatessaron (c. 170) and to ___Irenaeus___ (c. 180), who quotes 16:19.[101]

Q15. Why does the KJV include Acts 8:37?

a. The earliest Greek manuscript with the verse is Codex Laudianus (E, c. 550–650), but the confession is much older: Irenaeus cites it about A.D. 180, Cyprian about 250, and it stands in the Old Latin and the ___Vulgate___.

[99] Priscillian, *Liber Apologeticus* 1.4, in *The Works of Priscillian of Avila*, trans. Marco Conti (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), 36; Victor of Vita, *Historia Persecutionis Africanae Provinciae* 3.11, in *Victor Vitensis: Historia Persecutionis*, ed. and trans. John Moorhead (Liverpool: Liverpool University Press, 1992), 78–79.

[100] Henk Jan de Jonge, "Erasmus and the Comma Johanneum," *Ephemerides Theologicae Lovanienses* 56 (1980): 381–89.

[101] John William Burgon, *The Last Twelve Verses of the Gospel according to S. Mark Vindicated against Recent Critical Objectors and Established* (Oxford: James Parker and Co., 1871).

Q16. Did Erasmus back-translate Revelation?

a. Erasmus's only Greek manuscript of Revelation (1r) lacked its final leaf, so in 1516 he supplied 22:16–21 from the ____Latin_____. At 22:19 Latin witnesses such as Ambrose support "book of life" long before any surviving Greek copy.[102] The reading passed through the Received Text into the KJV.

Q17. Did Erasmus and the translators know Codex Vaticanus?

a. Yes. In 1521 the Vatican librarian Paulus Bombasius sent Erasmus 1 John 4–5 from Vaticanus, and in 1533 Sepúlveda sent him a list of its variants; Erasmus cited it on Acts 27:16 yet did not adopt its text.[103] The translators knew its readings through Beza and the Sixtine Septuagint of 1587. Their choice of text was __deliberate__.

[102] Jan Krans, "Erasmus and the Text of Revelation 22:19," *TC: A Journal of Biblical Textual Criticism* 15 (2010): 1–17; S. P. Tregelles, *An Account of the Printed Text of the Greek New Testament* (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1854), 20–23.

[103] S. P. Tregelles, *An Account of the Printed Text of the Greek New Testament* (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1854), 22; Desiderius Erasmus, *Erasmus' Annotations on the New Testament: Acts–Romans–I and II Corinthians*, ed. Anne Reeve and M. A. Screech (Leiden: Brill, 1990), 931.

Conclusion: The Word of God Endureth Forever

Every controversy over the Bible returns to authority. Beneath the debate over manuscripts and translations lies the serpent's question, *Yea, hath God said?* (Gen. 3:1), and the believer's answer rests on God's promises (Ps. 12:6–7; Matt. 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:25).

History confirms the promises. The line of Antioch, the Masoretic Hebrew, and the Byzantine Greek was received and carried by the churches; the line of Alexandria survived chiefly in __libraries__.

The King James Bible is not newly inspired. It consists of inspired words that God preserved and purified, and it stands as the settled Word of God in __English__.

> **Proverbs 22:20–21**
> *20 Have not I written to thee excellent things in counsels and knowledge, 21 That I might make thee know the certainty of the words of truth; that thou mightest answer the words of truth to them that send unto thee?*

The Great Conclusion of the Matter

a. Proverbs 22:20–21 gathers the course into five truths: God's words are *written*; they are *words of truth*; they are *certain*; they are *excellent things*; and they give *answers* to them that send to the believer.

b. Men of great learning who deny preservation lack one thing, __faith__, and so find no evidence that God could, would, or did preserve His words (Heb. 11:6).

c. The objections examined in this course, concerning readability, the Apocrypha, revisions, and the editions of Erasmus, do not overturn that conclusion. The believer's calling is to read the Word, believe it, obey it, and place it in the hands of __others__.

> **Isaiah 40:8**
> *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.*

REVIEW

Summarize the argument of the course in five steps, from inspiration to the King James Bible.

Appendix A: Timeline of the Bible's Transmission

Selected dates for the transmission of the Hebrew and Greek texts and the English Bible. Dates before the printing era are approximate.

Date	Event
c. 1400 B.C.	Moses completes the Law and commits it to the Levites (Deut. 31:24–26).
c. 445 B.C.	Ezra reads the Law publicly; the Levites give the sense (Neh. 8:8).
3rd–2nd cent. B.C.	Greek translation of the Pentateuch at Alexandria (Letter of Aristeas tradition).
c. 125 B.C.	The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[a]) is copied.
A.D. 45–95	The New Testament books are written.
2nd century	Old Latin and Syriac translations; P52 (John 18) copied.
c. 170	Tatian's *Diatessaron* includes Mark 16:9–20.
c. 180	Irenaeus, *Against Heresies*, quotes Mark 16:19 and Acts 8:37.
c. 240	Origen compiles the Hexapla at Caesarea.
c. 250	Cyprian, *On the Unity of the Church*, cites "these three are one."
313	Edict of Milan; Constantine favors Christianity.
c. 325–360	Codices Vaticanus (B) and Sinaiticus (א) produced.
c. 350	Ulfilas translates the Bible into Gothic.
382–405	Jerome prepares the Latin Vulgate.
c. 400–450	Codex Alexandrinus (A) produced.
484	African bishops at Carthage cite 1 John 5:7.
c. 500–1000	The Masoretes add vowels, accents, and the Masorah to the Hebrew text.
c. 930; 1008	The Aleppo Codex; the Leningrad Codex.
1380s	The Wycliffite Bible, the first complete English Bible, copied by hand.
c. 1455	Gutenberg prints the Latin Bible with movable type.
1475; 1481	Codex Vaticanus listed in the Vatican Library catalogues.
1516; 1522	Erasmus's first Greek New Testament; his third edition includes 1 John 5:7.
1517	Luther's Ninety-five Theses; the Reformation begins.
1524–25	The Second Rabbinic Bible of Jacob ben Chayyim printed at Venice.
1526	Tyndale's New Testament, the first printed English New Testament from Greek.
1534	Luther completes the German Bible.
1535–39	Coverdale (1535), Matthew's (1537), and the Great Bible (1539).
1536	Tyndale strangled and burned at Vilvorde.
1550	Stephanus's third edition of the Greek New Testament.
1560; 1568	The Geneva Bible; the Bishops' Bible.
1582	The Rheims New Testament (Roman Catholic).
1588	Defeat of the Spanish Armada; Beza's edition of 1588–89.
1603–04	The Millenary Petition; the Hampton Court Conference (January 1604).
1605	The Gunpowder Plot against King James fails.
1611	The King James Bible is published.
1627	Codex Alexandrinus presented to Charles I.
1633	The Elzevir preface: "the text now received by all."
1769	Benjamin Blayney's Oxford edition standardizes the KJV text.
1844; 1859	Tischendorf obtains leaves of Sinaiticus, then the bulk of the codex.
1870–81	The Revision Committee; the Revised New Testament and the Westcott–Hort Greek text (1881).
1901	The American Standard Version.
1947–56	The Dead Sea Scrolls discovered.

Date	Event
1952–2001	RSV (1952), NASB (1971), NIV (1978), NKJV (1982), ESV (2001).

Appendix B: The King James Translators

Fifty-four men were appointed in 1604; the names of forty-seven survive. They worked in six companies, two each at Westminster, Oxford, and Cambridge.

Company	Director	Assignment	Other members (partial)
First Westminster	Lancelot Andrewes	Genesis–2 Kings	John Overall, Hadrian Saravia, Richard Clarke, John Layfield, Robert Tighe, Francis Burleigh, Geoffrey King, Richard Thomson, William Bedwell
First Cambridge	Edward Lively	1 Chronicles–Song of Solomon	John Richardson, Lawrence Chaderton, Francis Dillingham, Roger Andrewes, Thomas Harrison, Robert Spalding, Andrew Bing
First Oxford	John Harding	Isaiah–Malachi	John Rainolds (Reynolds), Thomas Holland, Richard Kilby, Miles Smith, Richard Brett, Daniel Fairclough, William Thorne
Second Cambridge	John Duport	The Apocrypha	William Branthwaite, Jeremiah Radcliffe, Samuel Ward, Andrew Downes, John Bois, Robert Ward
Second Oxford	Thomas Ravis	Gospels, Acts, Revelation	George Abbot, Richard Eedes, Giles Tomson, Henry Savile, John Peryn, Ralph Ravens, John Harmar
Second Westminster	William Barlow	Romans–Jude	John Spencer, Roger Fenton, Ralph Hutchinson, William Dakins, Michael Rabbett, Thomas Sanderson

Stages of Review

Stage	Description
1. Individual	Each member of a company translated the assigned chapters himself (Rule 8).
2. Company	The company met, read the renderings aloud, compared them, and agreed on a text (Rule 8).
3. Other companies	Each finished book was sent to the other companies for review (Rule 9).
4. General meeting	Unresolved differences were settled at a general meeting of the chief members (Rule 10).
5. Final review	Twelve men, two from each company, reviewed the whole for about nine months (1609–10), meeting at Stationers' Hall, London.
6. Press	Miles Smith and Thomas Bilson saw the work through the press; Robert Barker, the King's Printer, issued it in 1611.

Sources: Pollard, *Records of the English Bible*, 53–55; Norton, *The King James Bible*, 54–55; Allen, *Translating for King James*, 28–35; Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 186–87.

Appendix C: The Rules of Translation (1604)

The fifteen rules issued through Richard Bancroft, bishop of London, to govern the translation. Spelling is modernized.

1. The ordinary Bible read in the church, commonly called the Bishops' Bible, to be followed, and as little altered as the truth of the original will permit.
2. The names of the prophets and holy writers, with the other names in the text, to be retained as near as may be, according as they are vulgarly used.
3. The old ecclesiastical words to be kept, as the word *church* not to be translated *congregation*.
4. When any word hath divers significations, that to be kept which hath been most commonly used by the most eminent fathers, being agreeable to the propriety of the place and the analogy of faith.
5. The division of the chapters to be altered either not at all or as little as may be, if necessity so require.
6. No marginal notes at all to be affixed, but only for the explanation of the Hebrew or Greek words which cannot, without some circumlocution, so briefly and fitly be expressed in the text.
7. Such quotations of places to be marginally set down as shall serve for the fit reference of one Scripture to another.
8. Every particular man of each company to take the same chapter or chapters, and having translated or amended them severally by himself, all to meet together, confer what they have done, and agree for their parts what shall stand.
9. As any one company hath dispatched any one book in this manner, they shall send it to the rest, to be considered of seriously and judiciously.
10. If any company, upon review of the book so sent, doubt or differ upon any place, to send them word thereof, note the place, and withal send the reasons; if they consent not, the difference to be compounded at the general meeting.
11. When any place of special obscurity is doubted of, letters to be directed by authority to any learned man in the land for his judgment.
12. Letters to be sent from every bishop to the rest of his clergy, admonishing them of this translation, and charging as many as are skilful in the tongues to send their observations to the companies.
13. The directors in each company to be the Deans of Westminster and Chester, and the King's Professors in Hebrew and Greek in either university.
14. These translations to be used when they agree better with the text than the Bishops' Bible: Tyndale's, Matthew's, Coverdale's, Whitchurch's (the Great Bible), and Geneva.
15. Besides the directors, three or four of the most ancient and grave divines in either university, not employed in translating, to be overseers of the translations.

Source: "The Rules to Be Observed in the Translation of the Bible," in Pollard, *Records of the English Bible*, 53–55.

Glossary of Terms

Alexandrian text. A text-type associated with Alexandria, Egypt, and represented chiefly by Codex Vaticanus (B) and Codex Sinaiticus (ℵ). It survives in comparatively few manuscripts but receives substantial weight in modern critical editions.

Allegorical interpretation. A method, associated with Philo and Origen, that assigns hidden or spiritual meanings to Scripture in place of its normal, literal sense.

Ante-Nicene; Post-Nicene. The periods of church history before and after the Council of Nicaea (A.D. 325).

Apocrypha. Jewish religious writings not recognized as inspired Scripture. The great Greek codices intermingle them with canonical books; the 1611 Bible printed them separately, between the Testaments.

Autograph. The first manuscript of a biblical book, written by its author or his authorized scribe.

Bibliology. The doctrine of the Bible.

Byzantine text. The form of the Greek New Testament found in the great majority of surviving manuscripts and transmitted throughout the Greek-speaking church; also called the Antiochian or Traditional text.

Canon. The recognized collection of books received as inspired Scripture.

Canonicity. The recognition by God's people of the books that bear divine authority, as distinct from uninspired writings.

Chirography. The handwriting of an individual scribe or period.

Codex. A manuscript in book form, with leaves folded and joined along one side, as distinguished from a scroll.

Conflation. The combining of two variant readings into one longer reading.

Critical text. The modern eclectic Greek New Testament (Nestle–Aland, UBS) that underlies most modern translations and relies heavily on Alexandrian witnesses.

Dynamic equivalence. A thought-for-thought method of translation that aims to convey the translator's understanding of the meaning rather than to render each word.

Eclectic text. A text formed by selecting readings from different manuscripts and traditions rather than following one textual tradition.

Edition. A particular printed form of a text prepared by one or more editors, such as the Greek New Testaments of Erasmus, Stephanus, or Beza.

Formal equivalence. A word-for-word method of translation that preserves the words and structure of the original as closely as the receiving language allows.

Illumination. The Spirit's work of enabling a believer to understand revealed truth (1 Cor. 2:12–14); it produces understanding, not new Scripture.

Inerrancy. The quality of Scripture by which it is without error.

Infallibility. The quality of Scripture by which, as the word of the God who cannot lie, it cannot fail or mislead.

Inspiration. God's supernatural act by which the biblical writers recorded His words; from θεόπνευστος, "God-breathed" (2 Tim. 3:16).

Interpolation. An unauthorized insertion of words into a text.

Jot and tittle. The smallest Hebrew letter and the small stroke that distinguishes one letter from another (Matt. 5:18).

Koine. The common Greek of the first century, in which the New Testament was written.

Lectionary. A book that arranges Scripture passages for public reading in the churches; the *synaxaria* begin the year at Easter, the *menologia* on September 1.

Majority Text. A Greek New Testament built from the readings found in most surviving manuscripts. It represents the Byzantine tradition but is not identical to the Textus Receptus.

Majuscule (uncial). A manuscript written in separate capital letters, typical of the fourth through ninth centuries; *uncial* is from the Latin *uncia*, a twelfth part or inch.

Manuscript. A handwritten copy of all or part of a biblical book.

Masoretic Text (MT). The traditional Hebrew text of the Old Testament, transmitted by Jewish scribes and furnished by the Masoretes with vowels, accents, and marginal notes; the basis of the KJV Old Testament.

Millenary Petition. The petition of Puritan ministers, said to bear a thousand names, presented to James I in 1603; it led to the Hampton Court Conference.

Minuscule. A manuscript written in a smaller, joined hand, typical from the ninth century onward.

Nakdanim. Later Jewish punctuators who supplied and corrected vowel and accent signs in Hebrew manuscripts until the printing era.

Old Latin. The Latin translations that circulated before Jerome's Vulgate.

Palimpsest. A manuscript whose original writing was scraped away and written over.

Papyrus. A writing material made from the pith of the papyrus plant; also a manuscript written on it.

Paraphrase. A restatement of the sense of a text in the translator's own words rather than a rendering of its words.

Parchment. Prepared, untanned animal skin used as a writing material; vellum is a fine grade.

Patristic quotation. A citation of Scripture in an early Christian writer, used as a witness to the text.

Perfect. From the Latin *perficere*, "to complete": complete and lacking nothing needed (Job 1:1; 2 Tim. 3:17).

Peshitta. The standard Syriac translation of the Bible, often supporting Byzantine readings.

Plenary inspiration. The doctrine that inspiration extends to all of Scripture.

Preservation. God's providential keeping of His words through history, to every word and mark (Ps. 12:7; Matt. 24:35).

Propagation. The carrying of God's preserved Word to every nation (Matt. 28:19–20; Acts 1:8).

Purification. God's providential refining of His preserved words through copying, printing, translation, and reception until they stand in settled form (Ps. 12:6).

Recension. A deliberate, planned revision of a text.

Revelation. God's uncovering of truth that man could not discover by his own understanding (Deut. 29:29).

Scribe; scriptorium. A professional copyist; the room set apart for copying manuscripts.

Scriptio continua. Writing without spaces between words, as in the early majuscule manuscripts.

Septuagint (LXX). A collective name for ancient Greek translations of the Old Testament; its nearly complete witnesses are fourth- and fifth-century codices that include the Apocrypha.

Soferim. The ancient Jewish scribes, from the time of Ezra, who copied and expounded the Hebrew text.

Supplied words. Words required by English but not represented by a separate Hebrew or Greek word; printed in italics in later editions of the KJV.

Text-type. A broad group of manuscripts that share characteristic readings.

Textual criticism. The discipline that compares the surviving witnesses to establish the wording of the text.

Textual variant. A difference in wording between witnesses, such as spelling, word order, omission, addition, or substitution.

Textus Receptus (TR). The Received Text: the family of printed Greek New Testaments from Erasmus (1516) through Stephanus, Beza, and the Elzevirs (1633), predominantly Byzantine and underlying the KJV New Testament.

Transliteration. Carrying a word from one language into another by its sound (e.g., *amen*, *baptize*).

Transmission. The providentially guarded process by which Scripture has been copied and passed down.

Universalism. The teaching that all men will finally be saved, held by Origen and others.

Verbal inspiration. The doctrine that inspiration extends to the very words of Scripture, not merely the thoughts of the writers.

Version. A particular translation of Scripture, such as the Geneva Bible or the King James Bible.

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